MACHINE TRANSCRIPT · CORAGGIO CONSULTING

Virginia Board of Education, Work Session (Part 2), Wednesday, January 24, 2024

Date	Wednesday, January 24, 2024
Place	Virginia Board of Education (Virginia Department of Education), Richmond, Virginia
Length	3h 34m (video)

- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=x-jeG1t7WDM
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

> Machine transcript (speech-to-text) produced by Coraggio Consulting. Not an official county record. Names and numbers may be misspelled; check the video at the timestamp before quoting.

Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-23. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:00:14] Okay. Welcome back, ladies and gentlemen. We are moving on to item B on our work session agenda. That's the presentation on our English standards of learning. And Dr. Sorensen, you and your team are going to be presenting this, correct? All right. Come forward, please. Thank you. Thank you, Madam President, Board of Education members. Thank you for having us here this afternoon for the presentation discussion around the Draft 2024 English Standards of Learning.

[00:00:50] I'm going to do the introduction slide, and then I'm more than happy to introduce the very capable and competent team that I work with that has done an incredible lift to engage the community and engage the Commonwealth in the process of looking at the 2017 standards so that we can bring you a draft of the 2024 standards. So what I want to put in front of the board first is the recommendations from the 585 work group, just to remind the board of education and the public of the cycle of standards review. And so I wanted to put that in front of the board of

[00:01:29] education to just remind us that we are on pace with the recommendations of the 585 work group in terms of revising the English language arts standards. So we're here in front of you for first review, and then hopefully we'll be back in March for final approval after we get stakeholder engagement over the next couple of months. So I again wanted to put that in front of us as a reminder of the 585

workgroup's recommendations. I think what you'll find here comprehensively is that the English language arts standards are a major overhaul.

[00:02:08] There is great work that has been done in alignment with the Virginia Literacy Act to ensure that we are fully aligned with evidence-based practices in the science of reading, that our standards are more rigorous and robust, that we lean into writing in a way that our standards did not before, that we lift up disciplinary literacy, strong text complexity, stamina in our readers, and we ensure that our kids are engaged in all genres of text so that

[00:02:45] they come out prepared not only for post-secondary careers, but for the workforce in front of them. This has been quite a journey of love for our team. We hit the Commonwealth as well as our institutes of higher education that the team will tell you more about in a very robust way over the past year so that we could bring you this draft of standards. And so to my right, I want to introduce the team that really dug into this work with our educators, with our folks in

[00:03:20] institutes of higher education, and with multiple stakeholders at various levels across the Commonwealth. So I will let them present their work to you. I will introduce Christine Harris, who is our Director of Humanities, and I have Jill Nogueiras, who is our K-12 Coordinator of Literacy, and then also Colleen Quesada, who I will call up here to do the presentation for you.

[00:03:52] But we look forward to the feedback from the board, and we look forward to the feedback that we'll receive over the next couple of months from the public through the public engagement hearings that will follow in the eight regions across the commonwealth and we look for a robust engagement process with stakeholders across the commonwealth over the next couple of months so that we bring you back a product in march that everyone can be more proud of that we can build upon throughout

[00:04:18] this process so thank you good afternoon madam president superintendent coons members of the board thank you so much for hosting us this afternoon for the opportunity to discuss the standards of learning with you um my name is jill no garis as dr sorenson said and i am joined today by my wonderful colleagues in the office of humanities and they have done the lion share of the work in bringing this draft to you today and we are really excited we represent a

[00:04:55] much larger group of educators institutes of higher education work groups commonwealth employees business members military members advisory boards this is the work of many many many many stakeholders over the last year and we are excited to present this first draft of the 2024 standards to you all i know that you are following along on your computers so i will let you know that i am going to quickly give you an update and quickly review the guiding principles that are included i know you all have a paper copy of the english standards of learning in front of you i know it's also in

[00:05:33] your board docs however it is you're looking at that but before we dig into the work of the revisions to the 2017 standards i want to quickly review the guiding principles that are here because i think you are going to find that they are embedded in the standards all throughout and have guided the work and kind of what we hope for the future of the commonwealth so just looking at these guiding principles you have that we are looking to inspire learners to embrace the joy of unlocking new knowledge worlds and experiences through the standards raise the floor and remove

[00:06:06] the ceiling for our students ensure that every child is reading by third grade on or above grade level prepare every graduate to be an effective communicator teach reading based on research and

embrace the science of reading strengthen foundational skills prioritize strong research analytical, and synthesis skills, ensure students demonstrate competency with reading, writing, discussing, and presenting a broad selection of both informational and literary

[00:06:40] texts and books, expose students to a wide variety of genres, authors, and great works prior to graduation, utilize technology and artificial intelligence as tools for teaching and learning around the ela standards but also as a topic of instruction in a safe ethical and responsible manner and to use judgment and a transparent process to ensure materials and topics are developmentally appropriate so these guiding principles are demonstrated and embedded throughout the k-12 standards and just kind of wanted to call your attention to those but in

[00:07:18] looking at our presentation, you know, looking, I guess we're now on slide four, if you're following along at home or with us here, I guess we're calling this the dice, we'll go with it. As you are aware, the Code of Virginia requires a review of standards at least once every seven years.

[00:07:36] With the last English standards adoption in 2017, we are on schedule to adopt revised standards in 2024. The 2023 Virginia Literacy Act legislation fleshes out more specifically the expectations for English standards in the Commonwealth, requiring that the standards of learning for reading in kindergarten through grade eight shall align with evidence-based literacy instruction and science-based reading research. Additionally, with direction from leadership and the board, our revision process moved forward, focusing on the engagement and feedback of a variety of

[00:08:16] stakeholders, raising academic expectations for students and schools, developing skilled readers to ensure that students are equipped to access educational experiences that prepare them for post-secondary opportunities, and create clear and coherent academic standards that will allow for common expectations of mastery in the commonwealth. Moving on to slide five, the English standards of learning encompass all grade levels, kindergarten through grade 12. While the English standards provide the essential skills and content to be covered in each grade, school divisions are

[00:08:54] encouraged to incorporate the standards into division-selected high-quality instructional materials and curriculum. Slide six gives you a little bit of update because since our last presentation to the board in February of 2023, and then the update provided in October of 2023, the English Standards of Learning have gone through a comprehensive revision process.

[00:09:21] Looking at slide seven, our first charge was to engage with the community to obtain feedback regarding the strengths and challenges of the 2017 standards. So as documented more specifically in your boilerplate, feedback was provided by the Virginia Association of Teachers of English, the Virginia State Literacy Association, the Virginia English Language Arts supervisors, parents, educators, community members, faculty from institutes of higher education, and business members. Seven community engagement sessions were hosted around the Commonwealth to receive such

[00:09:58] input. The chart in your boilerplate provides details on the locations, numbers of attendees, and comments collected. From this public comment, several themes emerged across different topics. While addressed in the boilerplate, highlights include the need for an explicit connection between the standards and science-based reading research, an attention to the spiral and build of skills K-12, connecting reading and writing, and clarity on expectations for various writing types. From here, the Virginia Department of Education English team transitioned into revision

[00:10:36] mode. Looking at slide nine, that gives you an overview of several key publications were instrumental in shaping the revision of the standards. Referenced on this slide are a number of notable frameworks, standards, legislative requirements, and bodies of research that encompass what's current in evidence-based literacy instruction and professional learning on standards development, revision, and implementation.

[00:11:03] As detailed in your boilerplate, a revision committee comprised of 52 educators, special education teachers, reading specialists, administrators, and school division English supervisors representing all eight superintendents' regions met for a week to review public comment, the aforementioned materials, and make recommendations to revisions on the standards.

[00:11:29] Ongoing revision work was completed by the English Standards Revision Steering Committee, and input was gathered from the English Education Advisory Board. VDOE staff facilitated the revision process and worked to complete a draft set of standards for external review.

[00:11:45] I would like to thank each group I just mentioned, of which there are many, for their input, and especially the committees for their work in this process. This fall, once we came and developed the draft, the proposed draft of 2024 English Standards of Learning were reviewed by our colleagues at Virginia Literacy Partnerships at UVA, several institutes of higher education, and a national expert.

[00:12:11] Looking at slide 13, slide 11, I'm sorry, 13 Virginia two-year colleges and four-year universities provided feedback on the proposed revisions to the Standards of Learning you see today. The participating institutes of higher education are listed on your slide.

[00:12:31] Additionally, drafts of the elementary standards were provided to Virginia Literacy Partnerships for review and feedback from September through November of 2023. The K-12 draft standards and feedback regarding coherence, clarity, and vertical alignment were shared with a national expert from November to December 2023.

[00:12:51] Comments and feedback shared with the English Education Advisory Board were shared with them so that they could provide their input, and revisions and adjustments were made, and the result is the draft you have in front of you today. So it has already undergone many iterations to this point. All right, looking at slide 12, the next few slides are going to highlight the changes, the comprehensive changes from 2017 to the draft 2024. So if you're looking at slide 13 you will see our first major change the 2017 english standards of learning were written

[00:13:29] to include four strands of content communications reading writing and research while the essential skills from 2017 are still evident in the proposed draft of the 2024 english standards of learning the new standards provide a more comprehensive approach to ensure students are engaging in more rigorous applications of the skills the 2024 standards are structured to maximize coherence and integration among strands which will help schools move away from skill of the week instruction and teaching and teaching isolated skills to connecting reading writing

[00:14:08] communication and research with a variety of texts following current research and literacy best practices, the proposed 2024 standards are organized utilizing the following 10-strand structure. Foundations for Reading, Developing Skilled Readers and Building Reading Stamina, Reading and Vocabulary, Reading Literary Text, Reading Informational Text, Writing Foundations, Writing, Language Usage, Communications, and Research. On slide 14, you will notice several

[00:14:43] notable changes from the most recent set of standards. These include the following, an emphasis on foundational literacy skills. The 2024 English standards are structured to begin with the foundations for reading standards to establish foundational skills at each grade level.

[00:15:01] Sub-strands included to address these areas include print concepts, phonological and phonemic awareness, phonics and word analysis, and developing skilled readers and building reading stamina. To expand on that a little bit more, the Developing Skilled Readers and Building Reading Stamina, fondly known as DSR, is designed to emphasize several key components of literacy development. DSR addresses the essential components of reading fluency, text complexity, textual evidence, deep reading on topics to build knowledge and vocabulary, and reading strategies

[00:15:38] Used to anchor the 2024 English Standards of Learning in grades K-12, developing skilled readers highlights the most critical research and evidence-based elements of literacy. The standards that follow provide the content of meeting grade-level expectations in relation to developing skilled readers.

[00:15:59] and coherence. The 2024 English Standards of Learning are structured to maximize coherence and make essential connections in and between the following strands. Foundations for reading, developing skilled readers, reading and vocabulary, reading literary text, reading informational text, writing foundations, writing, language usage, communications, and research.

[00:16:22] Grade level standards for English must be developmentally appropriate within a grade level and vertically coherent across grade levels to ensure that students continue to build and connect skills at each grade level. The focus of the standards emphasizes conceptual understandings and the integration of skills to provide building blocks from grade level to grade level and spiral K through 12. And text complexity. Following national research, the Virginia 2024 English Standards of Learning also include a section on text complexity within the appendix. Aimed at

[00:17:00] providing grade-by-grade specifications for increasing text complexity, this tool can be used to measure and provide students with text that match the rigor, expectations, and features of grade-level reading in order to ensure that students are equipped with the skills necessary for success in higher education, the military, or post-secondary endeavors. Moving into the how to read standards. The 2024 English Standards established foundational skills at each grade level in K-8 to align with the Virginia Literacy Act and ensure explicit, systematic, and evidence-based

[00:17:39] literacy instruction for our youngest learners. The substrands included to address these areas are print concepts, phonological and phonemic awareness, phonics and word analysis, and developing skilled readers and building reading stamina. These explicit skills are critical in ensuring that students establish a firm foundation in learning to read so that they can tackle challenging texts and engage in critical conversations at later grade levels.

[00:18:07] The new structure presents these skills first in each grade level to emphasize the skills readers need in order to tackle more challenging material. The foundations for reading skills target skills that young readers need to develop the pathways to orthographically map words and know words automatically without conscious effort. The next slide provides a sample of the developing skilled readers and building reading stamina standards. These standards are included K-12 and are designed to emphasize the key components of literacy development, addressing

[00:18:43] reading fluency, text complexity, textual evidence, deep reading on topics to build knowledge and vocabulary, and reading strategies. This strand is intentionally included directly after the Foundations for Reading and provides an anchored approach to grade-level learning in all grade levels. The standards that follow provide more specific details of the expectations for what a student would learn within a grade level when engaging in learning as anchored by this strand.

[00:19:12] Special attention on slide 18 was given to horizontal and vertical articulation throughout the revision process. This slide provides an example of the intentional and interconnected design. Through the integration of these skills, students are deepening their understanding and analysis through complex processes that cover a range of instructional opportunities and provides teachers the ability to introduce, emphasize, and reinforce concepts and skills necessary for students to become strong readers, writers, communicators, researchers, and problem

[00:19:49] solvers. The following slide depicts an illustration of the vertical alignment of the standards. This example follows one aspect of reading literary text and shows the deliberate crafting of standards that build in rigor and complexity with actionable and measurable language.

[00:20:09] While a simple example, all 10 strands have been designed to follow this model and build over the K-12 experience. The remaining slides are going to provide a quick overview of how to read the documents that you have, because we know you're all so excited to read them over the next month and join us on the road. So slide 21 provides for you a side-by-side document that provides the current 2017 English Standards of Learning on the left side and the proposed draft 2024 English

[00:20:45] Standards of Learning on the right side. Material may appear out of order as the restructuring of the standards shifted content to other areas within a grade level. So if you see a missing letter, it's probably somewhere else within that grade level. Slide 22 is the clean copy that you also now have a hard copy of in front of you. That is the clean copy of the draft 2024 English Standards of Learning. The last section of our presentation provides upcoming important dates and the next steps that we will be engaging in.

[00:21:20] If accepted for first review, the department will host 10 public hearings across the Commonwealth over the month of February. Six of these will be held in person and four will be offered virtually at a variety of times to accommodate working individuals and families.

[00:21:37] Feedback will be gathered over the course of February and any additional updates and or revisions will be applied. We anticipate, fingers crossed, that we will return for final approval at the march 2024 board of education meeting and at this time we would be happy to answer any questions you have or accept any feedback you may have

[00:22:00] dr northern all right i think they're phenomenal honestly you guys have done amazing work i just can't say enough how much improved this draft is from our prior draft or prior um and it's not because our last ones were terrible it's because the knowledge of science and reading has been so grown and more widely accepted um so i just four things just to consider and think about

[00:22:36] um one is the attention to disciplinary literacy um that was a big we've evaluated all the standards across the country in ela so that's a big thing that i think is not reflected in the draft so in other words kids as they get older in middle school and high school need to learn language that's unique to a discipline so the science language and the concepts of science and history like every discipline has its own

unique jargon um and and understandings that are unique to that discipline so i think we could use more attention to disciplinary literacy in the

[00:23:10] standards especially in the middle and high school grades i also think that the some of the best um ela standards across the country integrate this goes back to our prior conversation the pre-k and the um early childhood standards so especially the pre-k so if we've already got standards prior to my um you know arrival here that have been approved by this board um to see because we don't want to forget like the early childhood and the pre-k right we don't want to they're actually part of what we call the k-12 system so i would think about including the um at least the pre-k

[00:23:48] standards as well to show that we're starting i mean these skills start before k i mean you guys know that. It's pre-K. It's early childhood. We're starting to teach kids all of these fundamental letter sounds and all this stuff. So I just think that was one of the suggestions that we made when we reviewed the standards across the country, where that there were a handful of states, Massachusetts was one, I can't remember the other ones, that integrated their pre-K and early childhood. And it just made people pay attention more to those standards if they appeared alongside the K-12 standards. And the other thing I'd push for are text exemplars. We don't want a list. Oh,

[00:24:24] my goodness, we don't want a list of what every kid's got to read in every grade. We just know. But what we would like is because you guys have spent a lot of time teaching and showing teachers how to figure out what makes a complex text, why not, in the appendix, provide a list of exemplars from different cultures, different ethnicities, different parts of the world, different time periods for each grade level or grade band that illustrates what a complex text looks like for those grades. And again, it's not something that would be a requirement, and that's why we actually call it exemplars. This is another thing that really strong standards across the country do.

[00:25:04] In the appendix, they'll just provide teachers some examples of complex text at each grade level that meet your requirements that you spell out on how you should be deciding whether a text is complex or not. And then the last thing, just briefly, is I applaud the inclusion of AI. I think that that's exactly right. Like we're still trying to figure out what the heck we should be teaching kids about AI and we know they're going to use it. But so we just need to really teach them like how to use it and the proper ways and how it can, you know, make media bias worse and so on and so forth. I just wasn't able when I literally, when I just did an AI search, I kind

[00:25:43] of lost the thread. So I'm not exactly sure how that works. I saw it in the guiding principles, but I didn't see it so much in the standards. So that may have been my oversight, but just a better integration of AI, especially in the middle and high school, in terms of what we want kids to be learning about that, because it's changing so quickly. Thank you. Other comments or questions?

[00:26:09] Ms. Holton? Well, I'll join my colleague in applauding both your process and your outcome. You've put together, obviously, a really strong piece of work here, and I appreciate the fact that it's gone through our regular, robust, multi-year process where you, the staff, have involved a wide community of stakeholders in helping you get it right, and you've just done a phenomenal job.

[00:26:42] I have a couple of questions, and let me start with how, and I have some sense of the answer, but not enough, how on the K-5 parts of the standards, how much does this go above and beyond the work we've already done with divisions on VLA?

[00:27:08] In other words, it aligns with, but is there also significant new content that goes above and beyond VLA or is it basically just incorporating VLA? So I'll start and I'll let Jill follow up. One of the things I asked the team to do was work side by side with Emily Solari and make sure all of the strands, as Jill went through all of the strands, that the strands that talk about learning to be a reader, all of those strands align directly with anything that Emily Solari and her team have built in training, enroll at, and those kinds of things.

[00:27:40] So there was significant coordination around those strands. We know those strands are how to be a reader, but reading text, having the opportunity to hear text, those are things that are different components of ELA that aren't necessarily in the Virginia Literacy Act, so to speak. So it encompasses everything with ELA, but Jill has done a phenomenal job of making sure both on the pre-K side and the work that we did with pre-K with the Virginia Literacy Act to align, and in the K-5 to work very closely with the VLP and with Emily Solari's team. They took hundreds of comments, hundreds of tweaks, and went through and made sure anything where we used

[00:28:17] language that was a little bit different to make sure it lined up exactly with the same language that they're putting out with the Virginia Literacy Act. And then, Jill, do you want to speak specifically of the strands that are outside in K-5 that talk about more about the developmental environmental exposure to literacy versus the learning to be a reader components.

[00:28:36] Sure. I was also going to add, surprise, we're also your VLA team at the department. You may not have known that. We are ELA slash VLA. And so we work very closely with everything, all things Virginia Literacy Act. I also wanted to quickly add that in going through the core review the core materials review that virginia literacy partnerships did on behalf of the department looking at that k-5 core materials list if you were to look at the completed rubrics that are all posted you'll see everything that they were looking for in those rubrics is evident

[00:29:12] in these standards because we know that those rubrics would be completed before the standards were and since we are asking school divisions you know to adopt materials and start using these and implementing the virginia literacy act we needed to make sure that our standards would tightly align with that so that teachers didn't feel like they had competing priorities but yes we definitely have all throughout here and if you look through if you look through your draft standards you will see especially in the learning to read standards that you'll have several of them are only in

[00:29:45] kindergarten are only in k1 they developmentally kind of phase out as new ideas phase in based on on what's developmentally appropriate so we worked really hard with our partners at Virginia Literacy Partnerships to make sure that we were hitting those things with print concepts and looking at phonological and phonemic awareness and then moving into phonics and turning that into word analysis which then morphs into reading and vocabulary as you go up through the grades so kind of making sure that that happened but then also on the flip side making sure that you saw everything in the learning to read standards that are important for the Virginia Literacy Act

[00:30:20] reflected in the writing foundation standards and also in the language usage standards, because that should be reflected while speaking and while writing and while reading. So making sure that that language acquisition that makes students better readers is kind of evident across a strand and across vertically within, horizontally and vertically within all the K-5 standards.

[00:30:45] So, Ms. Alton, so I think I understand, I definitely understand that you have aligned thoroughly with VLA, which doesn't surprise me, partly because you're the same people, I get it, as it should be. And I think I also understand that within the K-5 world that overlaps VLA, these standards also go significantly beyond VLA in some areas.

[00:31:09] Absolutely. So the Virginia Literacy Act requires that the reading standards be written a certain way. And because we have the 10 strands now that are looking at, you know, your typical reading, writing, research and communication, but then expanded to include language usage, writing foundations, literary texts, nonfiction texts, all of that, it expands beyond the requirements of the Virginia Literacy Act.

[00:31:32] And then, so that, and also, obviously, the 2024, well, let me ask, let me not assume this. Am I correct from my rough looking at them, but layperson, rough, quick look, in the upper grades, 6 through 12, these 2024 standards go significantly beyond the 2017 standards.

[00:31:56] Most definitely. Okay. So then that leads to my big question, and this is, Dr. Koons, and I've talked briefly about this, but the implementation piece. So I get that you're on schedule for this. We are doing the 2024 revisions when we should be in the regular seven-year cycle, and yet I also hear that you're looking to accelerate the implementation.

[00:32:20] Now, you know, we usually have what many of us think is an excessive amount of delay, essentially, between when we adopt standards and when they're implemented, but there is a lot that goes on in that usual, you know, crosswalk year, et cetera, and so now I understand why we want to implement this in congruence with the VLA in the fall of 24, but how are we going to quit?

[00:32:50] and we're asking so much of our elementary school teachers, especially, but all of our teachers to implement this so quickly. What are the steps that we're going to take to get it? So number one, we would normally be doing curriculum frameworks, and I'm assuming that we haven't heard anything about curriculum frameworks, so I'm assuming that we're not doing those anymore. What are we doing instead of curriculum frameworks to give teachers a more specific idea of what they're going to be held, they and their students are held accountable for starting with their teaching in September. So what's substituting for the curriculum frameworks? What are we doing about textbook

[00:33:29] adoption? What are we doing about assessment rollout so that the teachers really should know by September what their students are going to be assessed on in May? It's not really, you know, and so the VLA piece, I think they do because that's been in process, the rollout for quite some time now, but beyond the VLA in the K through five grades and for all content in the upper grades, when are we going to let them know what they're going to be assessed on? When are we, the board, going to be setting cut scores? So walk me through in from now till, and whether this is

[00:34:04] you or your colleagues, how are we getting from here to September and getting all the things that the teachers need done so that they can effectively teach this new, really significant new content in September? I'm really excited. I can talk to you through September. When it comes to assessment, I'm going to have to kick it over to our assessment counterparts, but I can talk you through instructionally to September. And it's actually something that Colleen and I are very excited about because we are educators first and foremost. We have students. I have a husband who's an educator. We are immersed in education and we know how important this is for educators to feel

[00:34:43] like they can do this work. So while we are still in the planning phases, because we don't have completed standards. They need to be approved before we can fully implement anything. Because we also happen to be the VLA, ELA team, there is a lot of ongoing and upcoming professional development that is going to be available to school division leaders and literacy teams about preparing for implementation for VLA. As a result, they're going to be thinking about their division literacy plans. They're going to be thinking through their core material selection. They're going to be thinking through supplemental and intervention, what their reading specialists

[00:35:20] are going to be doing, and what core instruction looks like. There will be additional professional development that school divisions will participate in once they pick their core materials, because there's always a support and professional development that goes with high-quality instructional materials. So a lot of that is kind of kicking us off as we head into February through May for our K-5 educators. And we have the unique opportunity of piggybacking off of that and getting them in the room to be thinking about K-5 English as well. However, rolling that out and thinking through what's happening through 6 through 12, as soon as standards are approved,

[00:36:00] we will look at opening and implementing the textbook adoption process. We are also in the planning stages of thinking about professional development on the new standards and what will that look like. Thinking through beginning before the school year even ends. Thinking through virtual professional development opportunities that can be ready to go and recorded and just pushed out everywhere that anybody will listen to us. We want to be YouTube stars. That's our goal. But then also making sure that we are in every superintendent's region between June and August to make sure that

[00:36:35] we can offer professional development to K-12 teachers who will be implementing these new standards. So we are already anticipating that textbook adoption for 6 through 12 will kick off in summer of 2024. Now, as a former middle and high school teacher myself, I can tell you that the majority of textbooks that you're looking at for 6 through 12 are typically anthologies. They are collections of works. And what is so exciting, I think personally, I don't think I'm supposed to have an opinion or be excited, but what is so exciting about English language arts standards

[00:37:10] is that you can take whatever text you have, whatever you're working on, and you can start implementing these standards right away. They're not text dependent. So while you are looking at adopting new materials and you're looking at expanding and what textbooks will look like in ninth through twelfth grade, you can start doing these things, these standards right here with the piece in front of you from Shakespeare or poetry or a speech or an article because you can start implementing that now. So even if we don't have textbooks ready to go, we can put in

[00:37:46] professional development in place so that we can get teachers unpacking standards and understanding the new standards. Additionally, we are developing instructional guides. That's the new word, instructional guides that will help teachers understand the standard and how to approach the new standards as soon as they are approved so that we can get those. We're going to have a transition team in place. We will also have crosswalk documents similar to those that math had that show where the material has been added, deleted, a grade change, you know, the specifications

[00:38:22] of what changed within the standards. So, we are working on all of those things. They just can't be final, of course, as revisions are still ongoing. If anybody else wants to add. Ms. Holton, I'll jump on that in a minute. Thank you for that question. We are prepared to come back to the board in March with a slide

or two and an update to compact all of what Jill just prolifically said, because that's a lot to take in. As we talk about the streamlining of our processes,

[00:39:00] the streamlining of our professional learning, the streamlining of the documents that we've now created. We want to be transparent with the public. We want to be transparent with the board. And we also want people to see that it is methodical, it is coherent, and that it is available in time for our teachers to implement in a way that they feel comfortable with, that they feel supported by, and that they're prepared for the school year. So in March, we will come back and we will show you what that comprehensive plan looks like so that you can see

[00:39:36] it coherently put together. And then feel free again to give us feedback and ask us questions about the how again. And we're more than happy to reflect and adjust. Sultan. Thank you. That's very helpful. And I do think the longer, more detailed presentation of March will be helpful, but I also think you will hear these implementation questions at the pub or you will hear public comment about the the implementation questions i'm sure in february so the more you can put out there the sooner the better to help folks know how how we're going to make this work on an

[00:40:13] and it's an accelerated basis from what they've come to expect over the years and even if it makes sense to accelerate it change is always hard and and it's tough to do it as fast as you're talking about so i'd be interested to know when are the instructional guides assuming that we approve these standards. If I understand correctly, the instructional guides is what's going to be the substitute for curricular framework, or it's going to fill some of the same role as curricular framework did in the past in terms of letting teachers know at a more detailed level what they're going to be held accountable for when we get to assessment. Yeah, the instructional guides

[00:40:49] will fill some of that role. I will also say the 2024 standards themselves are fleshed out so much more in providing teachers with what they should be doing within a standard. So kind of fleshing that out and providing more detail. A lot of what lived in the old curriculum framework has been moved into the standards because we knew that teachers would need this right away. So instead of having to look at a document a year later to figure out what it means to talk about persuasive techniques, they are listed up in the standards now so that teachers don't have to wait for that

[00:41:28] additional support. We wanted to be mindful of that, especially because people don't want to look at four different documents to know what they need to do. Thank you. And if I can just, the textbooks, I get it on the middle and high school, the textbooks may be largely anthologies, as you suggest. And that essentially, I mean, I don't think it's feasible that school divisions are going to be purchasing new textbooks after we've gone through our process and time for September of 2024, but what you're telling me is they'll be okay with the textbooks that they

[00:42:04] already have because they're anthologies. They can use the new techniques with the old textbooks, essentially, if I understood correctly, and I get that for middle and high school, and I genuinely don't know the answer to this, but for elementary school, are we still expecting them to be using textbooks in conjunction with their VLA-approved curricula, or does the curricula materials essentially take the role, substitute? Are they going to have textbooks for elementary school English? And if so, how's that going to happen fast enough? That's a great question.

[00:42:43] So as a part of the Virginia Literacy Act, we're moving towards high-quality instructional materials, And thanks to the board, we have K-5 approved core curriculum. And so that's what our school

divisions will be using as their core curriculum.

[00:43:01] And so the term textbooks in our K-5 space is high quality instructional materials, and that's what they'll be adopting, if not have already adopted. Some of our school divisions are already ahead on that. And what you will also see from us coming to you in March are the supplemental and intervention materials for K through 8. So you will see those. And so the space in which we will look at supporting our school divisions is 6 through 12 with core. And so again, our standards are such that as people are looking at text complexity and reading stamina, the text that they have

[00:43:41] in the in-between as we go through a textbook adoption process can still be used as long as they're applying the new standard. So just one more follow-up. Absolutely. No, absolutely. So I get it that the VLA material will, curriculum material will essentially be in lieu of textbook for the piece that VLA supports, the science of reading. But as to the materials, as I understood from Ms. Noguera, that ELA does go beyond the reading content in the early grades. And so

[00:44:20] the curricula that we've already approved encompass, you know, writing and communications and literature. That's what many partners have. Part of those K-5 adoptions that the board approved. So once they've adopted that curricula, they're not going to need to go back and supplement with textbooks. They'll be supplementing with reading books. And in those high quality instructional materials, it addresses writing. It addresses text complexity. It addresses what we have talked about in terms of the science of reading, which is more than just the foundational literacy aspect.

[00:44:51] It is students being exposed to rich content. It is students being exposed to writing. It is students being exposed to language development. All of the things that our ELA standards address are embedded into those high-quality instructional materials that the board has already gratefully approved for our school divisions. Then I would just say the last thing I would say that i don't need to hear now but hopefully we can hear in march and maybe you all can put out there sooner if you've got it but when are the instructional guides going to be available and then the assessment piece when are the teachers going to know what they're going to be tested what their kids are going to be tested on and when are we going to be doing our piece to you know determine

[00:45:31] test cutoffs and all of that and again i'm happy to hear that in march rather than today and unless you want to do it i do think a lot of that is is very significantly determined by whether we when we adopt these standards, number one. Number two, I think I'd like to step back a little bit.

[00:45:50] I know that we all talk about high quality instructional materials. What that really means is exactly what we've been doing with history, with math. We're being extremely consistent in how we move through the processes as we go through these standards revisions and how then we address things like the former curriculum guides, the former documents that we all knew in the classroom that we depended on, those documents are becoming more fully

[00:46:22] fleshed out as resource-type opportunities for teachers as far as how they may wish to address certain parts of the standards instructionally. But they are almost exactly what the word means, resources and guides, not something to use as a crutch.

[00:46:44] Because I do think that we were using a lot of our materials in past years that we had provided. The frameworks were a crutch. It wasn't leaned dependent upon what the standards were actually saying.

[00:47:02] And so recognizing that moving towards more of a resource guide opportunity is going to give more oomph credence to the standards themselves.

[00:47:18] And I think that's kind of the direction we've been going with history, the direction we went with math. And I see it here very consistently as we're moving into these ELA standards. Ms. Ashton. President Casey, thank you. VLA team, wonderful job.

[00:47:33] I love reading them. I think it's important, when we say new standards, it makes it feel like it's like brand new. I wish we were saying clearer standards because when you see it from one to the other, it's just further broken down.

[00:47:48] I think this is empowering to teachers and to leaders versus being like very big picture. So I just applaud the team and say, you know, what we're doing is setting the bar really high for each grade and giving clarity to teachers on exactly what they should be focused on.

[00:48:09] I think the challenge is priorities. And one of the things you said earlier that I'm excited to hear back is now once you set the standards high, we know that kids are going to have gaps. And so the tools around remediation and acceleration, I think that is where the greatest opportunity is.

[00:48:30] And I know, so I'm wondering how we, as we're continuing to roll, I hate rollout because it feels like steamroll, as we continue to share and get feedback, how we then pretty quickly pivot to now that the standards are high, how do we close the gaps?

[00:48:48] To me, that's going to be the part that's most empowering to teachers and to leaders, along with, and I agree, we can't get to assessments until we adopt the standards. and given our accountability conversation it's like how do all of those come together standards assessments accountability framework because what we don't want is high standards high stake testing no acceleration and support and now these the great work we've done on standards which is just

[00:49:24] clear i mean that's why it's not new it's just clear gets undermined so i think just the the messaging around quite honestly what we're doing is is just as important as the like the literal standard so i just want to say thank you and keep up thank you and i just want to point out that in the middle of all that to the board's point is instruction yes right and high quality instruction and making sure that our teachers have what they need right which is the high quality instructional materials right we give them really great standards and then we give them great instructional materials

[00:49:59] so that they can do what they need to do in the classroom we empower them with great materials right and then it their cycle that you're talking about in terms of assessment just flows within that cycle um and then it ensures that every student whatever classroom they're in i think to the president's point um gets quality materials quality text ensures that every classroom within a school building is exposed to quality materials at grade level appropriate, right? Reach. So the

[00:50:34] scaffolds and supports then are there. And then that's where the focus is, because we're not spending our time necessarily on finding the materials, but rather on the instruction. That's great. Anyone else? Dr. Siebert? Again, great standards, great work.

[00:50:56] really appreciate what you're doing and and so my question it might actually be more of just a thought mindfulness as we move forward especially as we start talking about our work plan going ahead i think um there there are there are some just kind of harsh realities um and and the way our standards

work is kind of uh crunched up and and so there's like going down the interstate you know there's something slows things down traffic is goes but take a while get things spread out again and that's creating some some harsh reality so i love the timelines you all put together and the graphics with the timelines and showing where we are what's happening when and where we're going i also look forward to what's going to be the the next pieces of that because eventually we have to

[00:51:35] think about the those other parts i think as a board um and again i think the department and the staff do a great job out in the field you know supporting the fact that schools and divisions are all as different as the different children that they contain and so some of some of the harsh realities here are to come back to our work plan piece is that there is a bunch coming at that through it really close on the heels of one another and capacity to handle that varies widely it varies in the size of the division there are very large school divisions that have terrific people who get to fall asleep thinking about english language arts and wake up thinking about

[00:52:11] english language arts but there are also very small divisions where those people are thinking about english language arts and history and government and and oh my gosh the federal programs and doing our Title I audit. I mean, these people, there's just so much there. So the large divisions with dedicated people are, you know, are at an advantage. So that means we have to support the folks that don't have those resources. There's also the piece of, you know, I think it was touched upon, again, having taught high school, but been an elementary school principal, there is a difference. Even in a small division, small high school, you might have a

[00:52:48] department chair who is helping filter work and lead and guide those 6, 8, 12 English teachers through what's happening. But at the elementary level, where most of our teachers are teaching all the core content areas, they're doing it without department chairs. And if they're doing it in division without a dedicated team, falling asleep and waking up thinking about that content, this, no matter how we frame it or message it, is a lot. I'm not talking about English, where we are, the harsh reality of where we are now. And so I think that kind of support and effort

[00:53:24] in our work plan moving forward, especially about the implementation. Again, the idea of having much better standards and waiting two years to implement them, that doesn't make sense. But the idea of, you know, putting everything into the pipeline at one time, my heart is very much concerned about our elementary educators. And I know that we have great people who work that, but just like we differentiate instruction for students. We have to differentiate our support for the divisions that we serve. Dr. Goons? I think you guys have heard things that we are really working to focus

[00:53:59] on. And one of the things that Marcy and Katie are working on is regional support networks and making sure we have regional people in the field, in particular in our regions like Region 7, Region 6, some of our smaller regions that don't necessarily have those robust offices to have field staff that go out and support those so we're working to put that in place but obviously we got to get the standards adopted first but those are things that i'm really encouraged that the team are thinking about and and putting together and in place to roll in support both in the reading and the math space um because we've heard from the regions that they need someone boots on the ground to go side by side with them i will say one of the most exciting things i have heard on boots on the

[00:54:38] ground is that our instructional supervisors have started to come together again and this fall um may be happening in some places in the state, as you mentioned, as different as the children we serve.

But our regions are really starting to come together and building close practice across the instructional supervisors. So you might have been a math teacher and I might have been an ELA teacher, but when we come together once a month, we're really talking about implementation together and building each other's capacity. So it's really exciting. Hats off to these guys who are really working collaboratively to build those networks and those supports to think differently about the

[00:55:14] field in particular in elementary I sat with elementary principals on Sunday and asked them specifically what do you want to see from us how do you want us to roll this out to your teachers how do you want us to think about this and what is most important to you because it's important for us I would say our principals know this better than anyone else what are the capacities of the teachers in their building and so it's important for us to be close to them and they gave us some really good feedback but we're going to continue to work with our principals council every month to get their feedback and also our teacher advisory group to really help us think about what makes sense. But if you're hearing things or if there's places we need to sit down, I know

[00:55:51] we're sitting down with VASCD in the next two weeks to really start talking about what this looks like in a regional support kind of way. So we're excited to be thinking about not just being in Richmond and not just visiting, but how do we deploy teams that really help in different regions? Because I think that's a very important space that we need to move into and excited that team will be able to talk a little bit more about that in march thank you thank you very much please dr siebert and and just by extension i always want to start with the the students first and the staff who serve them but there's there's also going to be mindfulness here in terms of the uh the school boards and the local governing bodies and the appropriating bodies you know our friends

[00:56:30] who have experience on school boards know that often especially in a smaller division you're probably going to break your english language adoption up and you are going to focus on primary So yes, the anthology pieces, there's things that can be worked and transferred, but these massive core content adoptions generally carry along big price tags.

[00:56:50] I don't want to talk about just the books, but the other resources and services that go along with that. So again, that's the other thing we have to be mindful of is the capacity to be bringing on new materials for history, as well as for mathematics, as well as for language arts. And so I think the idea of what you have that you can continue to use is very important. But I think we can expect there to be a pinch in a lot of localities that we're just going to be sensitive to.

[00:57:16] Thank you. Anything else? I'll just note that we can maybe have this conversation more when we get to work plan, but I do see in the slide number two, Dr. Sorensen introduced the overall standards chart, the suggestion that we might be accelerating the science standards.

[00:57:40] And we did hear some feedback from the field on that, and so far what the board's action on that has been was our February 23 of this year, we approved a timeline for science that was consistent with the normal seven-year process that would be at least a year and a half behind this list.

[00:58:03] So that's a conversation I hope we have at some point, but we don't want to assume. I see that the department aspires to accelerating that timeline, and I look forward to a future discussion on how realistic that is in light of everything else.

[00:58:18] Yeah, and based on our feedback that we all received last week, I am meeting with the VASCD and their science team to talk through their concerns, so we can definitely hear that. Anything else on this item? Thank you, ladies. Thank you so much. All your hard work.

[00:58:34] appreciate your feedback see you on the road okay um we're gonna take about a five minute break so that our next presenters can get themselves set up and ready and we're taking a quick five minute

[00:58:49] break thanks okay ladies and gentlemen we are moving on to our accountability redesign discussion

[01:07:33] and i believe we have uh chad at the helm of this one okay take it away all right it's great to see you all uh this is hopefully going to be an interactive section i would love to hear feedback we're trying to gather feedback there is are some things that we're going to present to you of what we've heard from stakeholder convenings that we had around the state uh we have some recommendations

[01:08:11] or considerations for you all from things that we heard we also some things that we're putting in front of you for the first time and we want to hear your feedback on options on how to combine different elements into an accountability system so i'll start with the overview and timeline of where we've been where we're going as you all know but just to remind you in october you all voted to move forward with the accountability work and we are proceeding in november december we had a round of stakeholder feedback that we went to the eight regions across the state and presented on

[01:08:47] some of the information that we had already talked to you all about, primarily on indicators and how they folded into an accountability system. What we're hoping for today is feedback on the high level framework on how to combine indicators into a system, and then also starting to think about how to identify schools that need more supports, as well as how to fold in student groups and other considerations. Looking ahead, we're planning to bring back a draft for you all to look at of potential early workings of an accountability system in March, the March meeting. And then we

[01:09:24] would take that out for a second round of stakeholder feedback, where we could go back and hear from stakeholders on a more robust, fully developed accountability system. From there, the board would review and approve the new accountability system potentially in June. And then there'll be a first year of data collection and the full implementation of the cannabis system when the first results would likely come out in the fall of 2025.

[01:09:51] That's if we can meet all those deadlines. I will say if anything is pushed back from that, then we're risking pushing another year on the timeline there. But that's what we're aiming for. It's what we're working towards at the moment. All right. So the agenda for what we're going to do is we're going to report out on the stakeholder conversations on what we did, what we heard, and what we suggest based on stakeholder feedback.

[01:10:15] There are going to be some options for you all to weigh in on. And then at the end is more new things that we have not talked about is from the accountability indicators, how do we build it up into a system, and then a brief, hopefully, discussion on what comes next. So we had stakeholder feedback meetings in the eight regions. Dr. Koons went to all of them, and I went to some. My colleague Anne Hyslop also went to some. Katie went to some as well. Yeah, Katie went to all of them. We invited board members, local elected officials, and district leaders. We reached out

[01:10:51] to the public via the superintendent's memo, and we amplified through social media, radio, and print media. We had about 375 attendees. I believe you all have a copy of the full notes if you want to see those. The Hunt Institute coordinated them, and they were designated note-takers for those meetings as well. A broad range of people were in attendance from teachers and parents to school board members, division superintendents, and directors of testing.

[01:11:20] We presented on things that you all have seen before. On slide four, something that we talked about at the fall meeting is the combination of different indicators. So we talked to them about their feedback on achievement and growth and readiness, as well as anything else on their minds. We always had an open call for any other questions or comments. Okay. So what I'm going to do now is talk through some of the feedback that we heard. I'm going to go section by section. So I'm going to do what we heard on the feedback and then also some recommendations for how we're potentially going to use those and build into a new account of the system.

[01:11:59] We heard widespread acceptance that achievement matters. So there's general support that achievement is very important. We talked through the achievement index that we talked through last time. And there's broad support for that type of a way to measure achievement rather than just a pure proficiency, but of having an achievement index or a mastery index. But cautions that we want to keep it as simple as possible, so not to get too complicated, not to make it too sophisticated.

[01:12:29] There's also broad support for the inclusion of growth. So we talked about the VVAS system for measuring growth, and there was general agreement that the growth is important. And we're going to talk a little bit about weighting, but in general, I think people said equal weighting potentially, particularly in K-8. There were some questions around the mechanics of Vivos and how it specifically worked and the formulas, et cetera. The one thing I'll flag for this group is there was some confusion and concerns around high schools. So because Vivos looks from one year to the next and high school has two potential challenges. One is may not be a test in year one

[01:13:08] any test in year two. There may be a time lag, and that can create some problems for measuring growth. The other thing is on math, as students go to different types of tests, that can also add some complications for measuring growth at the high school level. Okay, so the other thing I'll say is that if you want to see all the comments, I would look at the Hunt Institute notes. What I'm going to focus on is the relevant comments pertaining to accountability. They don't have the Hunt Institute notes yet, we are missing two sessions. So we are trying to get those cleaned up and get them out as soon as possible. So we are working to get those to you

[01:13:46] in the next day or two. We just were missing two sessions. Yeah. The one thing you'll see in there is there's a lot of comments about lots of different types of things. And what I'm framing my comments today is trying to consolidate some of the comments that are relevant to the accountability discussion. There's lots of other things that we could spend time on, or you can read the notes for more. So how to proceed in achievement and growth at the K-8 level, we recommend or would consider using the achievement through a simple mastery index. We talked about this last time, and I've done some weighting on those. In general,

[01:14:21] the mastery index are very tightly correlated with proficiency rates, peer proficiency rates, but they're slightly different, and they work in a different way. One is that they give acknowledgement or credit

for students at different levels of performance, And so they also give more incentive for schools to care about students going from below basic to basic or from proficient to advanced.

[01:14:49] What else? The other things to note is that high schools have a slightly different mechanism for the number of performance levels than what K-8 uses. So we recommend a similar one, but it won't be the exact same.

[01:15:08] From now, based on what I mentioned on the high school growth challenges, we would recommend potentially not including them in growth measure in high school. It is more complicated and happy to talk through some of those, but at least for the moment, we would say maybe it's not the best time to incorporate it. We put a sample mastery index on slide eight if you want to see what those could look like. They're very similar to the ones that we put in front of you in the fall.

[01:15:43] They essentially give more credit to students who are going up the ladder, the biggest jump to students who make the jump into proficient, but there's still some credit for advanced as well. We also looked and saw whether there's some schools that are strong outliers, and I would say there's not that many of schools that have advanced kids that are compensating for students below basic. And so I would say that's not really too much of a concern with Virginia's distribution of students. Any questions on achievement and growth before we move on to the next step? Any

[01:16:18] questions, comments, feedback? I'm sorry, Chad. So knowing that you work with a number or have worked with a number of different states around this kind of work, I mean, is equally distributing the weight between growth and achievement something that's typical? Yeah, I can respond.

[01:16:45] I think it is fairly typical. There is quite a bit of distribution on either side. I would say achievement tends to be probably a little more weight than growth. There are fewer states that give growth far more weight than achievement, but it's close to, if not around 50-50. Dr. Steber, did you want to jump in? No, no, no. I was on my track. I had my slides run away. I was Okay. Dr. Gates, did you want to say something here? No? Okay, sorry.

[01:17:21] Yeah, the one thing I'll also say is we're not asking for a vote per se today. What we'd like is your direction and guidance. So we're going to get into a waiting conversation in a little bit. The next big topic area is the K-8 readiness measure. And I'm going to start with a discussion around chronic absenteeism.

[01:17:43] Similarly to achievement, there's widespread agreement that attendance matters. It's important for kids to go to school. And so I think people around the state understand that. But they also had some concerns that schools may not have full control over it. So there are things that schools can do to boost the rates, but there's still some things that are more innate to students and families that schools can't control everything.

[01:18:03] So I think one recommendation or one consideration coming in from that conversation would be maybe include it but don't have it as such a high weight. Given the current system, it has a very high weight, given that any one measure can drive a school's rating overall.

[01:18:20] The way that this will be incorporated as a balanced index means that chronic apenteeism, consistent attendance would not drive any one school's rating. The other thing I'll say about the K-8 readiness is there's a lot of interest in something else beyond consistent attendance, so some other measure, whether that's the 5C survey or other survey of SEL-type inputs of student performance or

student behaviors. The one thing that I'll comment on that is that we didn't have anything else to recommend for you all. If there's something

[01:18:55] that you all think is uh that you would like to see in that we would love to hear that love to hear that feedback um there wasn't broad consensus on any existing element that already could be applied the challenge is it would have to be something that is administered statewide and meaningfully differentiates across schools so uh there are uh there aren't that many things that actually meet those criteria that accomplish those things yes before ms holton speaks i just want to say if you all have questions please feel free to or comments please jump in here at

[01:19:34] any time yes please miss holton i know we'll get to discussion later but just on that specific point that i remember when you went through this the last provision uh uh we one of our goals was to have our state accreditation methodology align as much with our federal accountability requirements or federal plan that's a plan as we could and the feds require us to have something beyond the academic measures and we looked at things like school climate surveys and things that might or

[01:20:13] might not meet this readiness concept but that would be something else in the non-academic And it was just too hard with the data we had available then to find anything that met the federal requirements of differentiating schools and being available across different demographic groups, etc.

[01:20:31] We just didn't have the capacity. And I know some other states have done climate measures instead of chronic absenteeism. And I don't mean to say that it's not important because I think it is. And I think having an advocate of the measure, I am in support of it, but to find something else, if we tried to do something else in addition to or instead of, I would hope it would be something that would meet the federal requirements as well so that we don't have a state's statement of how the system is too different from our federal country and you may

[01:21:09] be able to tell us you know what are other states using in that spot are there any other things other states are using that we might want to look at or is everybody else falling back to front of absenteeism because that's what the data makes it easier dr kins yeah first i want to give a shout out to katie carroll because she has worked on the national level on federal accountability And it will help us make sure that we don't do exactly what you said and has helped us in the conversations.

[01:21:38] I will say across the state, I know we've kind of went very quickly through a lot of slides and want to back up just a little bit. We heard a lot of conversation in particular from elementary principals about could we use a performance task that's embedded and do something like that around readiness?

[01:21:56] Could we do things, as you mentioned, we had a lot of climate survey kind of conversations and talked about the difficulty in data, but a lot of opportunities and a lot of things came out of conversations about, could we use the data a little bit differently?

[01:22:12] So if we give an SOL test, could these five questions show readiness versus this? And I think that's dependent on, do we get to update the assessment system and get some really innovative pieces in the assessment system that allow us to have some flexible measures in the inside the assessment system that allow us to do readiness. So I think there's some opportunity there, but it hinges on whether or not we can update the assessment system to do some of the creative things that other states are doing in assessment items. So if we look across the country at some of the assessment items are extremely

innovative and allow us to capture thinking and writing and all of those things that you would think would be elementary ready

[01:22:51] and be standardized as you're saying but our current assessment system has worked very hard to keep up but we need some investment in those dollars as mentioned by the 5-8 and then pointing to this group because a lot of people on this board were on the 5-85 work group but that was one thing that came clearly out of there is if we are able to update our assessment system then there are things we could use in addition in the readiness measure and we heard that in a couple of different places, in particular with some elementary principals about some things they would like to see, thinking about demonstrating their readiness as students move on to middle

[01:23:27] school. But we also, as you mentioned, heard a variety of things about readiness that we can't measure. So I appreciate you calling that out. Ms. Holton? And if that's helpful for me to understand, Dr. Coonson, you say if we're able to update our assessment system, and some of that depends on the budget request that's now pending in the General Assembly for the assessment system.

[01:23:51] And assuming that that goes well, we're still talking about the assessment system, the new assessment system, if we're able to have one, it's a year or more away before we'll know what we might be able to do in accountability based, in other words, a little bit we're a cart before the horse to be doing accountability reform before we've got our assessment reform done. That worries me.

[01:24:16] Dr. Kim? I actually think we're lined up well because the General Assembly, as long as we have a budget after March, we have the assessment RFP, which will include those expectations in there. And there are items across the country that are there that we can pull from and move pretty quickly, but it will depend on when we come back in March, we'll have better information for you. So for instance, you might be able to come back in March to tell us what a readiness indicator might look like that we could include now even though we might not have the rfp done

[01:24:53] until later we could know what we're going to ask for in the rfp we definitely have the potential to do that the rfp is in final form to be able to do that depending on budget asks yes thank you for um clarifying so i'll bring up a couple things that um just may muddy the waters a little bit. But, and I think I've brought up before, so other states take the, and this may be what Dr.

[01:25:21] Koons is talking about, take the reading portion of their third grade standardized test and count that as the early literacy portion. So they're not double counting that, they're just aggregating that out, which is what Dr. Koons is saying. Okay, so that could be an early reading measure that would align perfectly with our early literacy and the fact that we're devoting so much energy to that. The other thing, and I'll just open it up, and I know some people hate this, but other states are using the percentage of children that are off track, so they're using their

[01:25:56] diagnostic district measures, and I don't know what that looks like in Virginia. I think it's just a patchwork of everything, but if we have some kind of consistency in our diagnostic reading assessment and just have, like, the percentage of kids in grades one through three who are deemed off track on the prior years, follow diagnostic. That's something other states are doing. Now, it makes people nervous because they say, oh, no, no, diagnostics aren't to be used for that.

[01:26:24] This is a summative measure. So I'm just putting it out there. But I do understand that using a diagnostic in an accountability system is sometimes a bad idea. But I'm just saying other states are doing

it. But if we are really looking for something for early literacy, I think it makes total sense for us to look at the reading questions on the standardized test? So I think that diagnostic that you're talking about was presented by Dr. Solari in the summertime. So

[01:26:56] we could probably go back into our presentations and see that just as a refresher. A couple. Oh, go ahead. No, go ahead. I was going to say a couple comments to respond a couple things. So One is a lot of states are using chronic absenteeism. It's 36 states and D.C. are using it as their federal accountability system.

[01:27:18] I wanted to amplify something that Ms. Holton said, that we're striving for one federally compliant system here. It does have to meet some parameters on the federal requirements of it has to be something that is standardized across the state and can meaningfully differentiate across schools. That is important that we're going to have as a reminder on several different indicators.

[01:27:39] The other thing is that this is, we're talking about the accountability system. There are still other mechanisms to talk about performance on whether that's the accreditation system, which isn't going away, as well as other reporting mechanisms or things too. And then Ms. Northern mentioned potentially slicing off the test in a different way. We had that in October, and that is an option if you all are interested in either slicing off a portion or potentially double counting if you want to say third grade reading is very important.

[01:28:08] And there are things that we could do if the board is interested in them. I'm not sure that we were in a place where we wanted to double count anything. So I'm not sure that that's an on-the-table option at this point. Dr. Northern?

[01:28:26] Sorry, I just forgot another point. Everybody hates chronic absenteeism across the country. Let's just be honest. And we saw it in our own public feedback because they feel like it's something that they can't control. And so I mentioned this the last time, and we've got SAS on board who are at the top of their game in the country.

[01:28:46] I'd love it if they could actually look and see if they could come up with a chronic attendance value-added measure, because some states actually are going forward with that now. And it's basically the same thing as a growth measure, except you're controlling for low income and SES, just like we do on the growth measure.

[01:29:03] So it's like the same calculation, except you're in the equation, you're inserting the attendance in the equation versus the test score. Anyway, we can talk about that, but I just want to put it out there that there are improvements out there for chronic absenteeism. Ms. Holton.

[01:29:21] And just on that point, our current system, and this is one thing I'm very interested in making sure we focus on, and I'm sure we'll do this more in March, how does what we're proposing to do change our current system? Because we're not creating something from whole cloth, we're we're working from something and hopefully moving the ball forward. Our current system does give schools credit, not the individual student level, but at the school level, it gives schools credit for progress on chronic absenteeism. So if your chronic absenteeism was through the roof last

[01:29:57] year and better this year, then you don't get dinged in the same way, even if you haven't yet met. And you have a number of years, two or three years, essentially, to reach the gold standard level on chronic absenteeism. And if you don't, then you still get dinged. You can't just keep growing to eternity and

never get to the promised land. But you do have, especially relevant in a time like now when we're coming out of a pandemic, I think we will see schools this year making progress. I know they are working on it. I know they're all, I'm working with some Northern

[01:30:34] Virginia divisions as part of my George Mason job on this topic, and they're all trying very hard to meet our goals for them and their goals for themselves because they know it matters to students' education. So I would hate to see us not include something on chronic absenteeism.

[01:30:52] I think we all know the literature shows schools can make a difference and that if they don't make a difference. If kids aren't in class, they can't learn. It's disruptive to teachers. For all the right reasons, we should be counting chronic absenteeism in some fashion, but giving schools a way to show growth on it, improvement on it, I do think is important, as we currently do.

[01:31:15] Mr. Sturdefin? I agree with Ms. Holting. You should count absenteeism, but not to the point that's a detriment to the accreditation of the school. Parents are more so now choosing to do things with their children that will impact the school in a negative way. But it's the parent's choice. They choose to take their children on a trip, an educational trip. If we can reduce the weight that the attendance has on schools, I will fully support that. You know, the schools do many things. They do the perfect attendance awards. They do the quarterly attendance awards. They

[01:31:55] send people to the children's homes. I think the schools do everything they can. However, sometimes kids don't come and because of that teachers teach um when the kids are in the classroom i don't think attendance should be used as a detriment if it has to be kept at all the value of it is reduced so it's not negative on the school's performance thank you i think um i think the shift to chronic absenteeism is the right shift

[01:32:28] and I could just only tell from my experience. I look at attendance every single day. I want it to be 95% attendance. I'm telling my teachers, I'm saying we have a strategy, call the moms, dads, get the kids here. But what we lose in that is the chronic absenteeism because we're just focused on the overall, like, hey, do we have 95% of kids in school today? And when this, just in the last month we shifted to say like no no who is chronically absent it's a completely different

[01:33:03] strategy there's different conversation we have 300 kids and right now it's 42 of them who are chronically absent so now we can change our strategy to those 42 versus a general like all school matters every day matters because it's not the same kids the attendance awards the recognition those kids are going to come and they should be recognized but the shift I do think is the right shift because it gives schools and teachers the the right focus to then change their

[01:33:37] strategy I think the why kids are not coming there's a whole range of whether it's a field trip or the safety or a job or illness of an older family member. There are lots of reasons why kids are not coming to school, not just they're not coming to school. I really do wonder if we could be even more innovative around what counts as coming to school for a day, for example. If you

[01:34:09] don't come to school but you log on and complete your work for that day could that count towards attendance because it's ultimately about getting the work done um so i so i'm for having chronic absenteeism because i do think it it prioritizes limited resources to focus on the right problem. And I wonder if there's more innovative ways to count, particularly for those chronic kids. I know a couple of my kids who just don't come to school. If I send them an email and

[01:34:46] say, do all of this work, they will do all of the work that day. And should that somehow be a way to count them as present? Mr. Sturgeon? So would the measure be work being completed or would it be attendance. However, if they're not there and they can make up the work, does that negate their attendance? I think you said you would call those kids and say do the work and the parents would do

[01:35:22] the work. The kids would do the work and that should count for something, correct? So it seems a greater priority is the work being done as far as the pacing versus the, it's important for kids to be in school, but if they can make the work up, does that lower the negativity of attendance?

[01:35:46] please so i think if you are chronically absent which means 18 days over a year and you miss one day in january but then you miss five days in february you are now completely disrupted in your own learning so to me it's more about if you miss today you get the work done you come to school the next day you can still stay on path to the learning but the disruption is what is throwing

[01:36:22] throwing kids off because when they come back now they're further behind and you can't actually catch up so it's not just like oh get the work done it really is about a sequence it is about the lack of disruption in your learning because each day builds on each day so that's why i wouldn't say oh well they can just make up the work i think the priority is be in person absolutely and there are some times when for whatever reason they're not it's like okay if you're going to be absent this day again we're talking about 18 days and 180 day school year which i

[01:36:58] thought okay 18 days is that a lot is it not two days a month it doesn't feel like a lot but it is a lot in terms of the learning, you know, the learning cycle. So I think, I don't know if that answers your question, but that's how I'm thinking about it. It's not just, oh, I'll get the work done, because if you miss two months of school, you can't just make that up. Dr. Toons? We have clear national data from the John Hobson's University about missing school and the impact it has on students nationally. We have clear Virginia data that on average, if a student is

[01:37:33] chronically absent, they score 18% lower in mathematics and 25% lower in reading. So we know that chronic absenteeism impacts students. We also have heard clearly from teachers across the Commonwealth when there are students here and not here and here and not here, that makes their job harder. So we know that. And we had a presentation in December, I just want to remind the board of about school divisions. Louisa County came and described how they are using flexible time and time that is not necessarily between seven and three to count towards attendance to make sure that we're thinking about those kids who might not be here and louisa did a great job of sharing

[01:38:09] they've shared nationally it's our statewide and it's something that we we are working to make sure that we can respond to to make sure we're thinking about attendance so if i took two and a half hours tomorrow in the evening because i was sick today shouldn't we count that in some way towards attendance. So we are working towards thinking about attendance, but making sure attendance means you're in person with the teacher, because that is the critical mass on what makes the difference for children's performance. And that's been well documented through the research at John Hopkins and well documented in our own SOL testing. Dr. Siebert? I think it might help just remember that

[01:38:47] part of the challenge we're wrestling right here is we are looking at this issue from the way we've always done it. And we're talking about not doing it the way we've always done it. The way we've always done it is accreditation has been switches in series not in parallel and so to be accredited you had to flip all seven switches all eight switches how many switches it was and we knew that any one switch

being off meant the light of accreditation went off so then we came with all these rules to help mitigate that and safeguard that and so the switch is only halfway off um and and it has to be off for three years and you know all these pieces because again this system was built, you were going to be accredited or not accredited, and any one switch could make you

[01:39:26] unaccredited. Well, of course, then we created accredited conditions. So I think a couple of things I just heard that I thought were really well said, and Board Member Holton said, we need to do chronic absenteeism in some fashion. So I think the last conversation was about what is the fashion. I think we also heard Board Member Ashton in this latest conversation that not all absences are created equal. You know, there's different types of absences. And right now, our systems don't accommodate that. Even the report we got in December, the great work that Louisa is doing, our current systems don't make it hard to capture that. Because if I'm absent on Thursday,

[01:40:04] my record shows I was absent on Thursday. Now, the fact that I came in on Saturday and served some time to make it up, I can't go now mark the child present on Thursday, because the child wasn't present on Thursday, but they now have done the work. And so, you know, that's where the nuances are. So I think, first of all, I think the heat in the room comes way down when it's not the one switch that can make you unaccredited. So I think that this approach helps with that. But I think there are some nuances. And it might also be that out the gate, we say it's going to be chronic absenteeism at a certain weight. But I think, you know, I've seen other states bring up,

[01:40:40] you know, systems where they also have a little placeholder saying, you know, stay tuned, Because in SY, you know, 25, 26, we also want to look at something else. So, I think that we can get at that. So, I appreciate this conversation. Chronic absenteeism is absolutely essential.

[01:40:57] It's about the fashion and the fact that not all absences are created equal. Now, the other thing I'd just like to say, if I could, while I have the mic on slide 8, I know we've moved into, we kind of went to 9 and 10, talking about chronic absenteeism. I would just throw out there that on slide eight, what I like about the left-hand chart is that these levels line up with the NAEP terminology.

[01:41:21] And so I think the more that we can, if NAEP is going to continue to be a tool that's going to be used to talk about Virginia, I think the more consistent our language, the better. And so that's why I like the left-hand chart on slide eight. Thank you. Dr. Northern?

[01:41:36] Yeah, I just want to clarify something that's really important. So the reason that we started measuring growth across the country is because achievement is directly correlated to poverty. There's nothing stronger when you look in education research than the direct link between poverty and achievement. The same is true with absenteeism.

[01:42:01] The poorer the district, the worse kids are in terms of attendance. It has to do with a myriad out of other things. So what a chronic, what an attendance value-added growth measure does is does the same thing, again, that the growth measure of achievement does. You just hold constant, the SCS, so the socioeconomic status of that child, you just hold it constant and take it out of the whole equation. So all the kids are now on the same level, okay? It doesn't matter if you're rich, you're poor, you're middle and class, or whatever. You've taken that out of the equation.

[01:42:35] So if a school is working their buns off, trying to get kids to school, knocking on the doors, going here, going there, having pizza parties, whatever they're doing, they are actually getting credit for

that. So you're controlling what they can't control for in an attendance growth model.

[01:42:52] You're taking the SES off the table because, let's be honest, it's unfair. It's unfair, chronic absenteeism is unfair because it's a raw measure. And so what some states are doing is saying, okay, we want the raw measure. We think the raw measure is important. We don't care if it's tied directly to poverty, okay?

[01:43:08] We just want the raw measure. It's like the proficiency, like we say with proficiency. We don't care that it's tied to poverty. It's a correlation. We don't care. But we could say that too. We don't care that the raw chronic absenteeism rate is tied to poverty and it's unfair. We're going to keep it anyway.

[01:43:25] But we're going to add, just like we do with growth and achievement, we're going to add another growth measure on attendance that controls for the poverty correlation, takes that off the table completely, levels the playing field for all districts and the schools that are beating the pavement to get those kids to work actually get credit. Right now they get no credit because the correlation to poverty trumps all these other things that are going on. It washes it completely out. So I'm only making a case here because I think it's really important because this is a national conversation around chronic absenteeism. There are ways that we can improve upon it. We've been at this a long

[01:44:02] time now. And this is one of the ways that we can improve upon it. So I'll get off my soapbox, but I think it's an important conversation. Dr. Myers, could you give us a little bit of info here? Dr. Myers is our statewide expert on chronic absenteeism. So he can tell you what our statewide data says. We actually just crunched this data yesterday in anticipation of some of this conversation today. No, I just texted SAS, though, the vice president to ask how that's possible and how that'll work. So I'm waiting to hear back from him. But we crunched and looked

[01:44:38] at city versus suburb versus town versus rural in looking at chronic absenteeism. And I'm just going to give you a couple of numbers. I think you are accurate that there are some alignments there, but I think it may be worse in suburb than you may think from what you were just saying with what our data are telling us right now. But it's stating right now that last year, so I'm looking last year's attendance. 53% of students were of significant attendance in suburbs. So nearly half

[01:45:11] the students. Significant was not at the 10% range, but just below the 10%. I'd have to look exactly where we matched that at. And 48% in city. So for significant, it was actually higher in the suburb than it was in the city. I don't know if you can compare that with socioeconomic socioeconomics exactly, but I'm assuming that the socioeconomics are a little higher in the suburb than potentially in the city. And then if you look, though, at extreme, it is 6% in the

[01:45:45] suburb and 13% in the city. So it is more, you do have more students with extreme attendance issues in the city than you do in the suburb. However, I just wanted to point out that there are still really significant attendance issues occurring in suburbs as well.

[01:46:04] And again, the correlation goes both ways. Just taking it off the table. Ms. Holton? So I just want to endorse Dr. Northern's suggestion that we look at and would love to have our experts come back to us in March with, tell us what other states are doing to look at chronic absenteeism on a growth kind of measure and tell us what we could do in Virginia, you know, do we have that option? Because I think that's really worth looking at.

[01:46:37] I do think that when we look at the data, we really need to look pre-pandemic and post-pandemic, but certainly what I've heard from divisions and some of them who collected some of their data is some of the pandemic and immediate post-pandemic attendance issues were broader, you know, there were strong students in wealthy families taking mental health days every other day. So I wouldn't be surprised at the data Dr. Meyer shared being different last year than it was three or four years ago. But the notion that poverty tracks, one of my biggest fears about this

[01:47:17] whole system we're looking at is it's just going to tell us what we already know, which is that poor schools struggle. And so anything we can do to help differentiate, not just telling us that, and when it tells us that poor schools struggle, it also, that's why, you know, index systems increase residential racial segregation and poverty income segregation, because these systems tell us that poor schools struggle, which we already know. So I would love to have us look at a vivos-like version of the chronic absenteeism data, see what other states are doing, see what

[01:47:56] options there are in Virginia. I think it'd be, I mean, I'm not saying whether we can do it or not, or whether it makes sense to do it, but I would love to have us explore that. Dr. Myers? I was just going to say, if they have done that, we will find out really soon what that looks like. Yeah. I did want to point out that we were modeling after attendance works. It was a study that was And we and we wanted to measure that our data was matching what their data were saying.

[01:48:21] And so the city, rural town and suburb were their categories, which we we have similar categories. But we could look at this at school divisions with 70% or 60% of poverty or greater versus those or use 50%, whatever percent we want and would give us based just on socioeconomic, not on whether it's a city.

[01:48:47] Because you could have wealthy cities, you could have wealthy, you know, so we could look at that more directly. I just wanted to point that out since this is being recorded that we were modeling this off of Johns Hopkins. I'm just clarifying, David, but they don't control for SES. Am I right about that? Or they're just breaking it out?

[01:49:06] correct and we we also have categories of this same thing in the state so it was easy which which is how they got their data and and we came really close there's a little bit of differences they had but we were yeah thank you miss ashton president creasy thank you i think uh one thing i i was curious if there was data on the rule so i didn't because you you mentioned uh urban and suburban so curious how rural fits into that is that a rural is better all the way around better attendance

[01:49:40] than suburb or city and the numbers are roughly yeah the extreme is about the same as city but if you look at high and significant they're both lower um i'm i'm more than willing to share this data yesterday yeah um but overall the bar parts are a little lower in the world than they do the Thank you. I'm surprised by that. So I have made a complete other assumption. So thanks for having that data.

[01:50:10] The other question I have, though, is so I'm not familiar with the value added attendance. So I would love to hear more about that. But it did raise for me the question around weights, because, you know, whether it's academics or attendance there.

[01:50:28] it is harder to um make as much progress for based on ses based on location based on rural urban so i i wonder where the conversation around weights happens in the overall accountability system

and the my my strong push is it is harder and for schools divisions and schools that are trying to do the work with the hardest to serve kids there should be um an incentive to do that not a

[01:51:02] disincentive and so making sure we are mindful of that because if they're if you're taking you know wealthy families are taking mental health breaks okay that's fine and kids and who can't do that are coming to school every day trying to close those gaps there should there should be an incentive for that so i don't know how where how are we thinking about weights yep yeah that is the next slide so if you go to slide 11 can i just um sort of i want us to move forward but i do want to

[01:51:35] caution us because part of the reason why we took on uh this project of uh bifurcating our accountability and accreditation system was to step back on the complexity of the current system and so i'd like to kind of reset our our thought process here to because i think we're having a lot of conversations that are making us get back to a place where we could be just as complex if not

[01:52:08] even more complex than we are currently we are focused on transparency and ease of understanding of this system, not so that those of us who are, you know, living and operating in this world from a professional standpoint every day, it's not for us to understand. I certainly hope we do understand it inside and out. However, this is about how our communities, how parents, how other stakeholders

[01:52:43] are able to clearly see how our schools are educating students, how student outcomes are being communicated to the larger communities that we, sitting up here, are serving. So just step back. Let's kind of refocus a little bit here. So let me walk you through slide 11. I will say these are very much in pencil. So we put some percentage weighting options down here for your

[01:53:17] feedback. Option one is a numeric. We're also putting this in the context of a regulation. So how much do we want to lock in of these are the weights we definitely want to go with versus we want to set some more textual descriptive parameters, but then leave it for other future board decisions to make more concrete. So option one has achievement and growth, both at 40%, uh, consistent attendance. We have some discussion about that. We can still have that conversation, uh, is on here at 10% and English language proficiency, which is again, is a federally

[01:53:53] required measure where that's applicable. So if, uh, there are a certain number of students that are, uh, English learners, then they would take that test to measure their English language proficiency and growth over time. And that would be calculated for those schools. If the schools did not have that, that weight would be reallocated to other things. Option two is? And those weights, like you put English language proficiency, not because these are from the notes or from the recommendations, just to give modeling out. I just want to clarify for the board and the public, these aren't things that we're not recommending that we use English language proficiency. You just wanted to show

[01:54:31] ways in which we could have options, correct? That's right. Yep. Simple examples. Very simple examples to get your feedback on what to go forward with. Ms. Holton, if you could mute your mic, I think we're getting some feedback. Sorry. Thank you. So option two is essentially that we don't put numbers in regulations and instead rely on descriptive language that would preserve the board flexibility going forward.

[01:54:56] If we wanted to do a study on adding value added in chronic absenteeism, that would be something you could then incorporate in an easier fashion. than going through a full regulatory environment. So were there other ways to have parameters around that, descriptive language on equal

weight, much greater weight, other types of textual language to signal the board's intent without locking you in going forward?

[01:55:24] And then option three is anything else that you've heard that you want to put on the table for the conversation right now? So I'll pause there, and I'd love to hear a conversation about weights, if there's other things on the indicators that you'd like to throw in as well, reactions to these very initial numbers. Ms. Holton? Well, I will just say that we heard from your colleague, Ms. Houslop, one of the very first presentations we did on this topic. So it may have been all of last fall. I don't remember before some of you were here. But one of the things I recall her saying is, if you don't weight growth heavily, then absolutely you are tracking poverty.

[01:56:04] And if you're tracking poverty, then you run the risk of increasing racial and economic segregation in your neighborhoods. And that is, as I say, a major factor for me in how we make decisions about this. So I would want to, whether or not we specify the exact numbers, I would want to say that growth is weighted at least half or at least comparable to achievement.

[01:56:33] Please, Dr. Siebert. So to your question, I don't know if options one and two are exclusive. I think we've already kind of talked about and heard about and just heard again the idea of using achievement and growth in parallel, you know, so whatever weights are so that they would be equal.

[01:56:54] And then I think, you know, I think really at this point, probably the 40-40-10-10 is fine as a placeholder, you know, for moving forward. It can be the straw man that we work from going forward. But I think maybe the qualifier there of option two is what we're saying is that achievement growth should be equal.

[01:57:10] Now, again, we're back to the idea of, you know, people in the field are going to say, well, show me the test. You know, so we're going to come back to the assessment piece. But I think, you know, this is probably good to move forward from with a footnote that, yeah, these are going to be equal. We're going to go under the hood of attendance, because really your third option is what else you heard from listening sessions?

[01:57:31] It was that not all absences are created equal. I guess I would want to throw out that we've, yes, we know that achievement is very clearly assessment based.

[01:57:48] But I think we also, when we're talking about growth, we need to know what we are talking about. Are we comparing apples to oranges or are we comparing apples to apples? And so that to me is a real wild card in the whole setup of how we determine whether we're weighting them equally or giving more weight to achievement.

[01:58:17] Because at the end of the day, you know, maybe I'm on the side that we do need to weight achievement a little bit more than we do growth. Because, I mean, if we're not, if we are not apples to apples in our growth measures, then where are we?

[01:58:37] Because that means that we're not measuring growth the same way in Alexandria as we are in Russell County, for example. So that's my issue. Ms. Holton? So two things. One is, yes, we absolutely need some uniform measure of growth.

[01:58:55] And so I think what's been presented to us is a vivas that would be working on the backs of our SOL achievement test. I would be interested, and I do think we heard some significant feedback from the

public that vivas is too complex, we don't understand it, and what about using a decent diagnostic growth measure?

[01:59:20] And so I would want us to hear about how we measure growth. I would hope that we think about how new assessment systems, if we're going to completely redo assessment, can our assessments give us better growth measures as well as achievement coverage.

[01:59:44] The one other thing I was going to say is I absolutely do understand that the ultimate goal is achievement. And the way we achieve that in our current system is we do not count growth at all at high school. So it's like we're growing K through eight, but high school, everybody's got to end up at the promised land.

[02:00:00] and so that is one way to weight achievement uh more heavily than growth is to and and as chad started to say it's i mean it's hard to make i don't i'd be interested to know how how do other states do any kind of growth measure at high school because at high school you're taking biology one year and and uh chemistry the next there's not a growth measure um and and Likewise, I mean, maybe English, but the subjects aren't as cumulative.

[02:00:33] So I think growth is really hard. I don't know how people measure growth in high school. So maybe the vivas magic does it. But so all that to say, one way to think about weighting growth less is timing.

[02:00:50] Elementary is different from high school. Ms. Ashton? Oh, gosh, so many things. So the one, I actually agree with you, President Creasy, like we want to keep the bar high, the ultimate goals, we want all kids to be masterful, proficient, and we know right now that we're not there yet.

[02:01:10] And so I am wondering the proficiency measure, I know from where I'm working, there's, I'm looking at the mastery index where it's basic proficient advance. in where I'm working right now, they are not counting basic as towards proficient. So they will only count proficient as advanced as the highest metric, which is really hard because you want to then see the growth. But that's where the growth metric comes in. Because if you are, if you're a school that right now has all your kids below basic, but next year you get all of

[02:01:49] them it's a basic that's a huge growth opportunity but it doesn't lower the bar that ultimately we want all kids to be proficient in advance and so I'm wondering if we define proficiency it's what's the bar for proficiency is it like the approaching is it the basic how are we think about that and then I have a second question but do you have thoughts about that so uh in uh slide eight the mastery index that would be tied to the proficiency level on the state test and then the the way it gets achievement is wrapped into the accountability system overall is through the

[02:02:29] weights and the scores on the mastery index so those weights would be essentially the achievement component of the accountability system so okay got it so if you're more proficient if you have more proficient more advanced then you're getting more points yeah exactly question you had a second question yeah or not do you want amber you know this really well and have really studied the mastery index do you just want to kind of riff on that for a minute for the board because i know you did before but i think we just need to bring it back for slide which one slide eight you've talked about ohio quite a bit in mastery index and how that was helpful in the achievement

[02:03:07] components i don't know if you're ready to do i'm sorry for putting you on the spot but be ready but Dr. Northern? Oh, sorry. I mean, I can pass around. I think Ann had showed it to us one time where, you know, you have how many kids that are scoring at each level, you know, multiply them, and then, you know, basically, then you give them the proportion that you've attached to that in the accountability system, and then it all adds up to a, quote, score, you know, on a zero to 100.

[02:03:37] I'm not saying that we're going to go that route, but a lot of states will make it a zero to 100 scale. And based on how many kids you have performing at each of these, this is just the proficient piece, right? And then we've got to add all these other pieces together. So this weighting is, you know, is only coming into play for some of those indicators on the placemat.

[02:03:58] But it actually doesn't say proficient. It's not binary anymore. I'm sorry. It's not binary anymore. So a lot of you talked about achievement being just a measure of these things. This measures everyone who tested and everyone who tested counts in some way, shape, or form.

[02:04:15] You're moving, you're giving everybody credit along the continuum of performance. And just real quickly, I mean, I think where I'm landing is just descriptors. I feel like, you know, we really want to do this right. I know all of us are really earnest about this as a huge endeavor we're trying to do to move move our system forward.

[02:04:37] And so I would be interested in looking into the diagnostic measures that other states are using what we're using how we feel about that or not for the progress of off track readers with the early literacy piece. i'd be interested in more discussion around just you know blocking off the reading items on our sol test to see if that's viable for our early literacy measure and on the chronic absenteeism side i'd be interested in looking at the growth measure and also looking at partial absenteeism that's another thing that states are doing they're able to track kids who are there for part of the

[02:05:15] day you know because sometimes when you take attendance after second bell and the kid comes in at third bill oh well too bad you've already been marked absent and it's a real game changer for the states who can measure partial absenteeism because they end up getting a lot more credit than the states that are not and districts are not able to measure partial absenteeism Chad yes keep us going all right let's keep going uh the next thing is is high school so we've already talked a little bit about this um I'm going to start on the readiness indicators slide 12. the the field

[02:05:53] what we heard is broad support for a variety of different readiness measures reflecting multiple pathways to college careers and military some interest in a civics measure as well which we talked about our last meeting i would say there's a general support although not universal on treating the measures as a cohort measure and what i mean by that is did students by the time they graduate complete some readiness metrics that that show that they are ready to succeed in the next phase of life rather than trying to say what are the readiness measures of each individual kid at the high school so it's more a cohort based of the graduating class of 2024

[02:06:31] we want them to all have some pathway going forward miss holton the cohort method is what our current readiness indicator is that's right that is correct yeah um so essentially keeping that as a way of signaling to the field that we want all kids to be ready for the life that precedes high school um there's also concern about turning it into a new combined rate we heard this called out of uh we don't want it to be too obscure and throwing in lots of things that aren't necessarily correlated to each other and we want to be able

[02:07:07] to tell the difference between uh the pathways and whether they're all equally rigorous or not i'm not going to spend any more time on chronic adventism except we heard this in the high school space as well um so what we would put on the table in slide 13 is sort of a readiness measure that's that's very similar to the current one the differences that i would call out would be the definition here is more based on actual attainment of different things as opposed to the current one has things like work-based learning or participated in a junior rotc pathway

[02:07:45] or cte pathway these are demonstration of the percentage of kids who reach different thresholds like earning post-secondary opportunities earning an industry credential in a high demand earning at least a 31 on the asvab you could also add bonuses for students who demonstrate different diploma seals so virginia has a range of different diploma seals including a civics and a stem um that the the accountability system could give credit for schools who uh help more students earn those diploma seals miss holton so uh what you would be subtracting here from what

[02:08:24] we currently we'd be clarifying some things around the military for instance and ideally we would be tightening up our risk of high demand occupations on the industry but what this what this would lose from our current system in any credit or work-based learning internships etc those some of them are incorporated into the various diploma seals so depending on how those were incorporated we could still include them that way but not for all kids necessarily that would worry me i think that i mean i know it's been they're a little fuzzier and harder to measure as

[02:09:03] concretely as a passing test on an industry credential test, but I do think that one of the big innovations we've made over recent years is encouraging schools to do more work-based learning, more experiential learning to support schools like the Hampton Division, working in the community and connecting with industry and getting exposed to career options, even if it doesn't necessarily mean a credential in the high-demand occupation. I just think that's a real advance that we've made, and it would be very unfortunate to give up. I do think that that was included in

[02:09:38] what Dr. Armstrong had presented to us earlier when we talked very specifically about this particular piece of our high school. This was, gosh, I don't know, August? Right, not that way, so that's why I'm questioning. It seems to be dropping out here. Okay, so maybe, Chad, we want to just go back and make sure. Sure, if that's, yeah. Yeah, I think, Anne, you're making a very good point. I think what Andy said over the summer is that as part of that credentialing, what he and Dave have worked on is incorporating work-based learning into that credentialing

[02:10:13] process. So it's part of that package process. Instead of it being a one-off certificate for like Microsoft Office, it's about the industry. It's the stackable pathway and the completion of that pathway, which includes that work-based learning experience. Yeah. And I know we have work your staff has worked over the years on defining work-based learning so that it doesn't just mean i went to a career for one time it does have to mean something but figuring out how we define it how we measure it how it how we make it real i'm all for but dropping it i'm not for

[02:10:47] miss ashton um this is remind me about credit requirements for high school graduation and we have them right okay so wondering about like a ninth grade credit we on track or readiness because the one thing i think you said earlier and i want to love to hear more is that it is hard to measure growth at high school because biology chemistry algebra geometry but i i think the data says that

[02:11:21] at the end of ninth grade if if a scholar is not on track for credits their greatest risk for dropping out. And so I'm wondering if we thought about a ninth grade on track metric as part of the accountability. Dr. Sievert? I was ninth grade assistant principal for a long time, holding the special place in my heart. And so I think that, yes, it's a huge metric. Back to the idea of keeping our system kind of simple, I'm hedging on that. I think maybe it would help to zoom out for a moment and just, first of all, I'm thankful to Chad and that this group and our board

[02:11:59] has been thinking about high school differently than elementary and middle school. I think eventually we're going to think about middle school a little differently, where eighth grade looks a little bit more like high school, and sixth grade looks a little more like elementary. But I think those are nuances we can come back to. I'm looking at a slide 14, and the idea of emphasizing four-year graduation rates, but also giving credit to extended year rates. I think to some extent it addresses the freshman thing, because again, if we're focusing on four-year graduation, that's great. We also need to celebrate the kid who graduates in five and the school kept him in and it kept her in and her in those kinds of things but I think just from this whole macro level piece which you keep bearing in mind that

[02:12:38] elementary is about foundation and even elementary's foundation is divided between primary and upper elementary and the way it works but elementary about foundation our middle schools are still largely about exploration and again that that exploration is different for the eighth grader who is still struggling in math versus the eighth grader who is knocking out geometry.

[02:13:00] And so I think that we realize that those kids are different places and the schools are doing great work there. But I'm okay with the high school being different in this approach because high school is about preparation. We go from foundation to exploration to preparation. If the high school is about preparation, we want to be careful not to box ourselves into what that preparation is because young people are going on different paths.

[02:13:21] So I like this part. I think the idea of using the diplomacy, and diploma seals who really haven't had a lot of meaning. I think there's some really cool stuff there. The last thing I'll say is, well, I think you just touched on, Ms. Ashton, is linked to this, just like all linked to all this is our assessment work, linked to this is our high school redesign work.

[02:13:40] It's one of the things I didn't bring up earlier, but I was excited to hear about in English and the idea of losing content in our English at the high school level is because we do have credits that you have to earn, but as long as we keep those credit numbers large, then we squeeze out opportunities for CTE and early college and workplace and a whole bunch of other stuff.

[02:13:57] So I'm glad that we're looking at high school differently. I think we need to continue to, and I think there's really cool stuff we'll be able to do there and link to this. Ms. Ashton? Yeah, I agree. I personally hate the credit requirements because it does lock you in to say, like, a kid is not interested in this and they want to do this, but because you have this, you know, so it, but I am wondering about how you, But it's just like the early, it's an early warning.

[02:14:26] If you're not on track for something at ninth grade, then how do you wait till the fourth or the fifth or the sixth year to be able to take action? So, but I agree, I want us to remain innovative, but I also want us to have the indicators that maybe something is, maybe there's some lessons learned or there's an opportunity for intervention, but high school's tough.

[02:14:58] - Dr. Siebert? - And I think the thing you're saying there is that you could actually look at eighth grade, eighth grade middle school readiness, including how many of your eighth graders are accumulating credits or demonstrating those things. So there's really, I think there's cool work we can do.

[02:15:15] - I think if I could just jump in real quickly, I absolutely love the diploma seal idea only because I'm a big liberal arts proponent. I was not one who knew what I wanted to do the day I set foot in college, much less high school.

[02:15:36] So, I mean, I think we've really got to give kids the opportunity to have as many experiences as they can have to give them just the openness of the world and what the opportunities are out there for them.

[02:15:55] So, you know, yes, I'm just not someone who's wanting to push kids down a particular road just because they show a little bit of interest in something, give them broad experiences. So as much as we can support that, while at the same time supporting those kids who are highly focused on one particular route or another.

[02:16:22] Dr. Northern? Yeah, just real quickly, and I've mentioned this before, I'm just getting increasingly concern, not just here, but across the country, dual credit is getting to be like, just passing it out like candy, to be honest. And, you know, it was the original intent is that the kids are actually getting a real higher education experience with a higher ed faculty. And it's turned into, you know, something that's not that. And so I just would continue to encourage our folks who are

[02:16:56] working on CTE and so forth, to just make sure that we're holding the line on dual enrollment and dual credit. Yep, I appreciate all those. I've been taking notes. Dr. Siebert already teased up a little bit on the graduation components, so I want to transition us to that. It's on slides 14 and 15 if you want to follow along. The one thing that we heard from the field is to emphasize the four-year graduation rates, but also consider giving extra credit to extended year rates,

[02:17:31] whether that's five-year or six-year. There were mixed opinions on pathways beyond the standard and advanced diplomas. So there were quite a few concerns that too many students were being pushed into alternative diploma types, applied studies, and certificates of completion. So we're going to get into that as well. A couple options about proceeding. And one I just want to make sure that we're all aware of is that if we go to the federal system, the federally compliant system, we do have to include the four-year adjusted cohort rate. Virginia currently uses that as their federal

[02:18:07] school accountability system. They use the federal four-year rate. That would mean necessarily discontinuing the GCI, the graduation completion index, which includes all diploma types, including GEDs and certificates of completion. That's about 3.8% of students across the state that are graduating with some of those diplomas. That doesn't mean all those students would not capture or not qualify for the federal four-year cohort adjusted rate. It does mean that some of them would not. And so that is an issue that I think stakeholders would be concerned about. So I'm curious. I'd love your feedback on how to think about these

[02:18:44] issues, how to think about potential weighting of them, if you have a particular preference on extended year rates or any other options or thoughts on these. Ms. Holton? And just to be clear, I think what we're doing currently is we do a state graduation rate and a federal graduation rate. So we report both

and we use the federally mandated definition for our calculations of the federally mandated school interventions and then we use the state definition of graduation for our

[02:19:22] state accountability and it is unfortunate that they're not in line it's not overwhelmingly i don't i mean it basically means our state graduation rate looks a few percentage points higher overall and on a school by school basis than our federal graduation rate and we do we will have to keep reporting the federal graduation rate if we don't if we either need to adopt the graduation rate or we continue to have a bifurcated those are kind of the options i think now you could say we're going to use the federally compliant system in our school identification system but

[02:20:00] then continue to report the state system so basically flip the way that they're working right now um but yes if you want to put it in the system it should be the four-year or the extended year cohort rate anyway we don't have a current we don't currently have an extended one that's We do have an expanded one where we include GEDs, et cetera, but I don't think we count the five and six year now.

[02:20:28] So we have expanded but not extended graduation is the difference between the current Virginia rate and the federal definition. I can add a little color on this as well as context for you all. I haven't seen it for Virginia. I don't know if it's collected here, but nationally, going from four-year to five-year adds about 1% to a school's graduation rate, which is not a lot from a state level.

[02:20:55] If you go from five to six-year, it adds like 0.3%. So it's not a big difference. The differences are some places, some schools might be particularly affected by those changes. Ms. Hulton? It might be interesting, you know, if we're going to keep two lists, One question would be, are they differentiating different schools?

[02:21:16] So it would be interesting in your modeling for us to run. Does the federal graduation rate really identify different schools for intervention purposes than the current state definition or a state extended adding five and six years?

[02:21:32] And if not, we can report different rates just for states, I mean, for localities and high schools' own sense of their progress. but if it's identifying the same schools for intervention no matter which definition you use then i'll be for let's go with the federal right because it's simple so you know our schools that are graduating more with ged's or more five and six years is it somehow differentiating schools differently that would be worth knowing we should be able to run those yeah that's good all right well i would transition us then to uh slide 16 which is options

[02:22:11] for waiting. We have two, as Dr. Krug mentioned, these are very early preliminary numbers to get your feedback and reactions. They aren't that different in terms of the percentages. Those are two options in numeric terms, or if you like the sort of descriptive language, that's also on the table as well. If we're doing it in K-8, I think it makes a lot of sense to continue doing it in high school, but I'm open to, or we would love your feedback, and any thoughts on your reactions to

[02:22:41] what's on the table here? So sorry, I'm going back a slide, Jad, or two, but I see where the public was talking about an interest in a civics measure, but don't know what, and so I wonder just if we could entertain for this bonus. I'm trying to think, like, where could that go, and we have this bonus for students who demonstrate readiness in multiple ways, and I wonder if one opportunity for demonstrating readiness in civics given that we've really killed ourselves on high quality civic

[02:23:15] standards is you know maybe you give seniors a if they register to vote and if they pass the naturalization test they can get a diploma seal in citizenship or something like that I mean because I'm I know that we all are passionate about civics and I'm just trying to figure out we don't want to mandate that all the kids take the naturalization test but I'm just trying to kind of work that in in terms of it. And I know a lot of districts actually require seniors to register to vote before they graduate. So anyway, I just thought that might be something we could talk about in

[02:23:48] the civics area. We can kind of skip that. I like that idea. Chad, is that on your list? I was actually looking at the seal in civics education. It doesn't have voting or the federal citizenship test. It does talk about Virginia and United States history, earning a grade of B or hire. It's about attendance and no disciplinary infractions. It's completing 50 hours of voluntary participation in community service or extracurricular activities, et cetera.

[02:24:20] And we could have the community service piece alongside the other pieces that Dr. Northern was describing, but I mean, this is our decision, right? So that might be. But am I right that the civics diploma seal is one we award too, so we might want to rework that as an option. And to include some of those things, I'd also love to see participation in debate team or competitions, you know, that kind of nature, the we the people, etc. There's a lot going on out there that would be great to encourage and recognize and reward. I think that's a great

[02:24:59] way to think about it as fitting into the readiness indicator. That way we're not ignoring it, but we're not over complicating. Dr. Sievert? To your question about the weights and things, I'm kind of thinking where I was in the great conversation the colleagues on the board had during the elementary and middle school piece is maybe we do this graphically, not numerically, sort of like we did previously back to the placemat idea that we say for, you know, for elementary and middle school, we're talking about a big block is achievement, a big block is growth, and then

[02:25:38] two little bars underneath for chronic absenteeism and for English language proficiency. Then here at high school level again we're we're kind of changing it to its achievement and graduation and then a bar that's kind of readiness and and in this way because i don't know if we're ready to lock in on numbers as we've talked about but i think we definitely are on what are the big pieces in the mosaic versus what are the little pieces in the mosaic the other thing i'll say on that approach is that um gives us more time so we can have a regulation that is potentially more descriptive

[02:26:17] in nature, but then for the SS state plan that we have to show to the feds and for an accountability manual that we get ready for schools and districts, those are where the board can lock in and make those decisions and have more time to run more data, et cetera, as well. Dr. Hans? And Amber, I think you said that earlier, you voted more for the descriptive measure. So I think what we're hearing as our next step to come back in March is have some kind of descriptive components with some options on the items that we've taken notes on. Is that what we're hearing both on the elementary, middle, and the high school, so having some kind of descriptive spaces where you can

[02:26:52] actually see some of these things and map them out, is that the right space? I like that approach. I would want the description to give a little guidance, so that achievement and growth and graduation for high school be more heavily weighted than other criteria, and that growth be weighted at least as heavily as achievement. Those would be my proposed language. And recognizing there might be, those might be, others may have different views. And that last piece, that growth

[02:27:30] weighted at least as heavily for elementary middle. Dr. Coons? So a model with some language behind it that you could react to. Okay. We can make that happen in March. Yeah. Actually, that's all I have on what we've covered so far. So now we're going into journey and ground that we have not covered as a board and uh some important decisions on how the system holds up and rolls up together um are we ready for that conversation any one want to make any last comments on the sit the

[02:28:04] components and waiting etc oh sorry all right let's go to slide 18 and this will sort of lay out where i'm going to try to take a bad i think maybe we we might want to pause to see us maybe be getting some modeling of what we're asking for next month before we jump in here and like further what do you think well complicate the conversation i don't know the challenge is um modeling what so we need to figure out what we're looking for exactly and that's why some of this

[02:28:44] conversation um would be helpful for for us as a team to think through sort of what to bring back to you all uh are you worried about time like because i could no i think they're worried about capacity to think through any more spaces and and i do like the direction that dr siebert was going in with his sort of mapped out idea he had in his head of of a visual type opportunity for us um to then kind of move move the chess pieces around if you will um to where we want to see

[02:29:22] what it looks like I guess is everybody do you think we should keep going here do you think we need a little bit more of a map and then add maybe um please I think there's there's interesting content here but I think maybe we should almost have it like as a show and tell like priming our pump for future thoughts and let and again if something jumps out and grabs us but I there's some slides here that intrigue me um so I'd kind of like to have him motor through the next half Okay. So let's go ahead and go through it. And then maybe there's some comments at the end of

[02:29:59] what you're going through that we can add. Yes. I can also jump to key ones if you'd prefer that. Just proceed however you wish. All right. Well, the slide 18 sort of gives a framework for the topics that are still outstanding. So it's good to think through Dr. Siebert's talk about the placemat or sort of how it all fits together. So we have this funnel of the different components, and they are going to go into a couple different decision points. One is on ratings. Another is on

[02:30:33] identification of schools for supports. And then another is how it all folds into the accreditation system. Unless we get legislative change, the accountability system will have to live sort of within the accreditation system. They can feed and flow into that, and we can present some options for how that can look. But that is something that's still going to exist. So I'm going to jump to slide 23. And these define the types of identification. So which schools we have to

[02:31:09] identify. And they align pretty broadly with, I think, Virginians would want as well. The first is called Comprehensive Support and Improvement. This would be schools that need a large dose of improvement. The federal minimum is that they're the lowest performing 5% of all schools for all students. High schools with grad rates below 67% of all students. There aren't many of those in Virginia. And also schools that have persistent gaps that aren't able to close those gaps over time. And then the bottom list there is called Targeted Support and Improvement. Those are

[02:31:46] schools with consistently underperforming groups of students. One of the options or one of the directions that we would like some feedback from the board is on slide 24, is how to start identifying schools for improvement and where to set various cut points. And there are three options here for you. The first option is to say, let's use a percentage-based system. We're going to say it's X percent of schools

are going to need support, and that's how many VDOE can support, and so that's how many schools we're going to identify. It's basically a normative ranking.

[02:32:24] You say, I'm going to pick a percentage, say 10%, and you say all the schools in the bottom 10% get that support. The 11th percentile school and above does not get that support. So that's called what I call a normative-based system of how to define the schools that need support. Option two is what I would consider a standards-based system. This would be like defining a criteria or a point value and to say, here are the cut points of difference rating system. Probably the one you might be familiar with is like an A through F system of how to define which schools go into which categories. And that is you have to identify a pre-establish a cut point. You need to

[02:33:03] do some modeling to figure out where those cut points make sense. But then you don't necessarily know where schools are going to land. You're saying it's a standard base, more like a rubric, and schools distribution falls where they may. Option three is sort of a hybrid approach. So we say in year one, we're going to say we think we can support about this many types of schools.

[02:33:23] And then those are going to be the cut points going forward. So it's a way to transition into the system. But over time, you lock in those cut points and say, that's how we're going to choose to set the cut points going forward. Those will be the cut points moving forward. Any questions or comments on that before I move forward on to other components?

[02:33:52] Ms. Hulton. I bet it's hearing me from there. So I think what our current system is would be the standard space rather than the normative space.

[02:34:11] Is that right? Yeah, I would say it's a standard basis. and i think what i'm hearing is that right now we have i mean the five percent of comprehensive intervention schools is five percent right so we got a hundred eighteen hundred schools that's 45 schools but the uh the the lesser level of support the targeted intervention that can be a really high number and i think it has grown a good bit and frankly unless and until

[02:34:43] we have resources in the office school quality that right now they're inadequate and sadly for reasons i don't understand the governor's proposed budget positions from our office of school quality rather than expanding it as i think we had all hoped based on our conversations last year we don't know what's going to happen in the general assembly but to me have schools in a intervention strategy status that we cannot support is serving no use so i would like to say

[02:35:21] that we set a normative when such that our staff can adequately so if we're supporting five percent 45 schools in the comprehensive status and that's essentially by federal definition we don't have any flexibility over that i would love to have a cs support not more than another five percent in in the targeted intervention strategy just so that we can actually usefully provide some support.

[02:35:47] It doesn't mean anything if we can't do anything for them. And I would like to point out that unless our recommendation, our board recommendation about at-risk add-on comes through or unless there's some other change in the budget, we are not sending extra resources to support these schools and states that have actually moved the needle on the comprehensive support schools and the targeted support intervention I've not just had money for an opposite school quality oversight component, but have actually sent real resources of a significant nature with oversight to those schools to help improve things.

[02:36:27] And until we get to that level, I'm not sure that we're really going to move the needle the way we want it. It takes resources as well as the scrutiny to make change. So all that to say, I would have us limit our TSI schools to a manageable number.

[02:36:49] And that's not meaning that there aren't other schools that need help. It's just that there are, you know, realistically no need to commit to this help where we're not going to do it. Other comments?

[02:37:10] All right. If we're sort of limited on time, the next one I would go to would be how to include student groups. So we have not talked about this at all. The system that we've talked about so far is overall totals across all students.

[02:37:31] So how to include student groups in ratings. So if you jump to slide 29, there's a couple options that are pretty common across states. Option one would be to rate schools based on all indicators for all groups of students.

[02:37:46] So essentially combine the rating. And so if it's 40% overall for achievement, you divide it by each of the different subgroups that the school might have and add that up. So Black students, Hispanic students, students with disabilities are all getting a proportion that get added to the school total.

[02:38:06] So that's option one. Option two there is to say we're going to run the system for the different groups. And then if the groups are lower performing, we're going to lower the school's overall rating. And essentially, a student group can then change the rating for the overall school's rating.

[02:38:28] So we have an example there of if it was meeting expectations or rated meeting expectations for the overall students, but there was a student group that was performing lower, then it would get bumped down to developing on the rating. Any feedback on either the percentage inclusion or more of the bump sort of notion of option two?

[02:38:58] Dr. Siebert? I'm going to have to think about this a little bit more. But, you know, while slide 30 says it's the simpler approach, I immediately see, you know, the decision rules. Well, you don't want a school with this meeting getting jumped to developing if the end or the percentage is so small or did it happen over two years.

[02:39:19] So I definitely, we need to be accountable for every child, and we need to be looking at every reporting group. But I don't know if, you know, the meaning to developing, I think there's going to be a lot of debate over what are the triggers there.

[02:39:37] You know, was it just one year? Was it a three-year rolling average? And now we're creating complexity again, which I want to try to avoid the complexity. So what can you tell us about the option one and what people are doing and what are the pros and cons? Yeah, I would say it is less frequently adopted option one, but there have been some states that will choose a specific weight for subgroups to capture and say they're going to capture a certain percentage of the overall system.

[02:40:12] and then it gets broken down based on how many groups are meeting the qualifying threshold so the sample size the end size there determine how many different groups the school might have this this might be an area where we need to really for our stakeholder groups to to inform and uh yeah this is an interesting chat thank you i'm just not ready am i right that our current so currently we have a gap closing indicator that is a separate indicator from the others you know an additional indicator of additional switch that said the patients have

[02:40:51] to flip and use this analogy but i think it is based just on eating a mess and i do think that using whatever whatever we do in depth for you may be a way to simplify it would be to continue that focus on healing as long as that meets the federal requirements because i assume it does for what it was yeah any other comments feedback guidance on things you want to make sure happen

[02:41:31] in either the school rating conversation or inclusion of student groups question in general just going back to your earlier point president creasy which is like what's the purpose of this it's transparency it is more information to make good decisions and i think the timeline is year to year like we you know kids don't have five ten years to go through fifth grade so to the extent that there's transparency at the end of the year for a family for school for a school division

[02:42:11] that to me has to stay the purpose and not making it overly complicated and i don't think in the charter world it's no longer than five years like after five years of being persistently at the lowest end. That's where, to me, the greatest intervention or decision has to be made. And I think the other conversation around resources was a good one. And you could have a bad year, and that shouldn't be the end of the story. And so I think how we think about it over a period of

[02:42:50] time is important. So that's how we do that. I'm confident that you will figure that out. But that's where I end. Dr. Northern? I mean, this is another random comment, so I don't know if I'm answering your question, but when you ask about other groups that we're maybe concerned about or want to see, I mean, we're going to have a conversation tomorrow about advanced learners, it looks like, and, you know, and we want to broaden the pipeline of advanced learners and

[02:43:26] how we make that pipeline more diverse and identify more of those kids who have promise and talent. So I would say in other, again, other states do this, that we would have a subgroup of advanced learners, whether those, however we choose to define those, whether they're kids who've been identified through a formal process, whether they're kids who are in the top 5-10% of their school level distribution, I mean, however we want to do it. But I do think if, again, we want to align our priorities with our system, that we ought to track somehow, some way, the needs of advanced learners not just the needs of our um you know of our low our low achievers we want to track

[02:44:06] our high achievers too anything else before we move on we do have one more item on our agenda miss holton i would love to see us tracking and whether accountability is the right place to do it or not i don't know but how well are our schools doing offering advanced options because that's one of the big questions is not how the students are doing on it but they can't take an AP classes that's not offered and at some point in our accountability system we could be helping incentivize and encourage all of our schools to be offering more broadly recognizing their

[02:44:44] challenges of all sorts but with virtual virginia options for instance there's no reason they can't all offer their AP classes so if there's a way to think about leading in percentage of students opportunities of advanced courses um and then i had just two um overall one one this one may be minor but thinking about this this indicators we have now and what might be getting dropped the gap closing you're addressing i'm looking at the fact you have to look there at the science

[02:45:20] but we do do indicators in science in virginia now are we going to include them yeah it would be included in the achievement index so all the required tests would be included thank you and then my last thing is just that you know one of our big goals had been to separate out accreditation from accountability there is no legislation that's been submitted to the general assembly by anybody as far as i

can tell that would achieve that goal this year so whatever system we're adopting on the schedule we're talking about anyway will be an accreditation

[02:45:55] system not an accountability system of my terminology and so i guess my question would be and this may be we really would need to hear from counsel at something what can we do what flexibility do we have within our current legal structure to call this something different than accredited with conditions for instance but in other words the thing a good bit of our current system is embedded than the statute, and how is that going to be reconciled with what we're talking about doing?

[02:46:29] That doesn't have to be today, but at some point, we need some of that. Dr. Siebert. And I think, Chad, slide number 31 really kind of tees up that conversation for us in terms of, you know, we're probably going to have to work within some pretty narrow guard rails in the coming year, and as we do that and as we develop some really, really good ideas, I think that informs the legislative ask for the next session. But yeah, I think, Chad, you've got that there on slide 31. Any key observations you'd share with us, even though

[02:47:06] we're out of gas? Yeah, I mean, Ms. Holden is correct that the accreditation system would still exist. We'll work with the legal counsel to make sure that everything is compliant. I think at this point, we would anticipate that there is a way to create an accountability system that feeds into the accreditation. So you could still think of them as two things. The accountability is the subcomponent of accreditation. Accreditation would still exist. All the existing, most of the existing rules would still exist, but the accountability portion would be siphoned off and sort of a subset of that. The last thing I will say is just to say we're hoping to be back

[02:47:45] in March. We'll have some data runs for you all to look at. I think we'll have some more advanced text for you all to look at and react to. It'll build on some of the things that we covered as well as things that we didn't fully dive into. It's more time for that. And then after that, we're planning for another round of stakeholder feedback. So once we have that more fleshed out system feedback from you all, we would go back out to the field for additional feedback.

[02:48:10] Dr. Keynes? That, of course, we won't go out for feedback until you guys are ready for us to present something. So if we come back in March and you're like, we need one more bite of the Apple before. The timeline is dependent on what y'all feel comfortable with us moving forward. I just want to reiterate that we have an aggressive timeline and we can slow that timeline down to make sure that we are meeting what you guys need us to meet so that you feel confident with those decisions before we would go out with any models. Dr. Northern, I'm just curious what

[02:48:42] these data runs are going to be. Well, definitely some indicator level data runs. We can do that on something like the mastery index on growth, hoping to have more on some of the readiness type of indicators. And the rolling up together depends on what we think is worth modeling out at this point. Thank you, Chad. Thanks. Yeah. All right. Do we want to take a break for us to then come

[02:49:16] back and dive in the work plan? So five, seven minutes, enough time to walk the other side of

[02:49:26] the building okay ladies and gentlemen we are back um and we are moving on to the last item on our

[03:02:34] work session agenda today which is the discussion on the board work plan um who's driving this discussion. We are. All right. So, yes, please. So, in the conversations in November and December

around the annual plan, Dr. Northern, you asked us to create a work plan. Our team took a stab at a work plan, and you asked us to make the work plan around the priorities in the annual plan,

[03:03:09] or in the five-year comprehensive plan. So, this is probably not what anyone wants exactly. This is a starting point document, and you will see draft in dark bold letters on the top on purpose because we roughed out some ideas and are really looking forward to you tearing apart this document and giving us really good recommendations on how you want us to move forward.

[03:03:34] And so the three department members left in the room are happy to take notes on your recommendations so that we can build a version two on the work plan for you. I'm gonna turn over to you comments been here so um let's get into it what can we do

[03:04:05] Ms. Hulton so I know we're all brain fried I certainly am um but um try to turn that one but I when I do a work I would love to see us do a work thing where we think first is painful about I love how this is organized around our side and I would also like to see us say well what are all the things we actually just have to do this year because we have to do them and then even if it's a really cluttered work even if it's really full over full perhaps then we can

[03:04:42] at least have something we can look at and then deal with the pressure so and i would also love to have us suggest that it goes through a full year so i like starting in march since we're talking you know we won't adopt it before march but that if we can take it march through march just to give us a year's window so little things like um you know we have to do an annual report that's just actually required to do an annual report so we know in if we're going to get started on an unreasonable amount of time that we would want that presented to us in an initial discussion

[03:05:18] at least by september and in october we could look at a draft in november we have about i don't know if those are the right but something like earlier well then okay yeah maybe maybe we want to start And that will also help if they're not going to have a special meeting in August and we know we need it if September isn't early enough and we know we need it in July.

[03:05:39] So just thinking about, you know, what are the things we know we have to do? And one I saw right up there's an annual report, but also, don't we have to do this year? I don't know how we're going to do this, hopefully your amazing staff is going to help us, but we have to do SOCs for school construction, whatever that means.

[03:05:59] But whatever it is, it's big and new and nothing like anything we've ever done. And therefore, I would like to have us start on that. You know, if it's due to the General Assembly by November 1, then we want to start on that by, you know, I mean, I know we mentioned it, but we haven't actually seen any.

[03:06:21] We have a work group working on it right now. There's no one in the room on that work group, but we have a work group working on that. So we'd be happy to kind of, this is really helpful that these are the kinds of things you want to see mapped out. Do you want them on this big overarching space?

[03:06:37] Do you want it all to be cluttery? Or do you want something that like dives into layers? What I would like, what would be most useful to me is have a calendaring system such that we can see, oh my gosh, July's got a lot on it.

[03:06:52] So is there anything, you know, if we see all the July things in July, then we can go, oh, we got to move some of that to June or some of that to September. So I think, too, you know, what are some of the

statutory obligations as far as reports and such that we have?

[03:07:09] And we need to give those, you know, whatever those things are, whether it's, you know, whatever it is, needs at least, you know, three months before the due date, we need to be presented with it.

[03:07:26] obviously dependent upon how you know technical we need to get with the document but i think at the very least we need to have it three months ahead and that's for the ones that are ours right correct now there may be some that the government this year are going to tell the department that the board should i mean if they sell the department that's a different thing but if they tell us this year that we have to do something i know kind of which they do but you But I think she's right that three months is a good norm to track towards where it's doable.

[03:08:03] Oh, another thing I would want to put on the calendar is thinking about what are the things we're going to need formal public hearings on, because that scheduling, and you all are, God bless Jim, trying to help us all manage our personal calendars to be all across the time and all, and so I know that we're going to need, presumably we're going to need to be out there again at some point on amability accreditation, depending on when science, you know, that's what we saw earlier, suggesting that we're going to recruit final science

[03:08:36] SOQE and SOL in January 2025 would mean we need to do publications in the fall on science. I would suggest maybe a little bit of ambitious, but laying it out there in the chart will help us decide if that's doable.

[03:08:56] So what else do we need to be co-adherent about all that regulatory work we saw last time? We saw that list of things that we're going to be looking at reviewing quite a few of our regulations. And I assume that those require public hearings.

[03:09:12] And maybe they can be combined, but they don't require public hearings? That's it. But the periodic reviews require us to look at things. So when is that going to be in the chart or is that going to be throughout the year? Dr. Siebert?

[03:09:30] No, I like this as a starting point. It's always easier to start with something to look at than a blank sheet of paper. So thank you for putting something down. For example, I think it makes sense that we're looking at the priorities from our plan. And so, but I think some additional rows, for example, look at priority one, higher expectations.

[03:09:49] I like that we have the English standards on there and we have our accountability discussion on there. But some of those things, those two of those things in particular, are going to run a much longer stretch of time. So it's almost those could become their own rows.

[03:10:04] We could have our accountability conversation as a row across the bottom so we could know when we're going out for informal feedback versus when we're doing things. And then the same with the standard. Yeah, and that's a chance we're doing plopping some Nora things that we might need to. But no, this is a really good start.

[03:10:28] So I'd challenge us to, yes, on all the regulatory stuff, all the things that we got to do, aligned to the comprehensive plan. But what I'd like to do is really hear from, start integrating like teachers do, our guiding questions for a board meeting, you know, so just to time with what we're struggling with. So, you

know, a big question, maybe how do states, you know, how do states develop their high quality CTE pathway programs? Or, you know, who should we, what non-test

[03:11:05] score measures should we be considering for our accountability system? Like, so we have a guiding question that's sort of, you know, going to be at least a focus, a part of the meeting. And then we use that to then start thinking about who we want to ask to present. So both state and districts, like our schools. So I think we all love hearing and hearing our schools and our districts and what they're doing. And I know they love getting attention for their work. So if we had somebody doing some great CTE thing, and our guiding question is how do we make better CTE pathways, then they would present that meeting. Or if we had an expert from Colorado who's doing phenomenal

[03:11:44] things around CTE pathways, then we would know three months in advance, hey, let's ask the Colorado expert to this meeting. So I guess what I'm trying to do is come up with sort of a big picture guiding question, like a lesson would be structured around, not that it's going to perfectly fit everything because it won't, but maybe it's just, you know, two hours of the work session is devoted to this question, something like that, because I know we can't just have a question run for two days. But yeah, use it as an opportunity to problem solve. Like we've got some really meaty questions and debates and like this chronic absenteeism thing just kind of turned into

[03:12:21] that. But we could easily see a guiding question for today's meeting could have been like, what are the pros and cons to using chronic absenteeism, you know, or whatever. And then we could have, you know, heard from districts, we could have heard from a state that's got attendance value added, whatever. So you get my larger point, which is just to have a guiding question and then use that as an opportunity to hear from our districts that are doing cool things and other states. Yeah, and that particularly applies to the work. We can use our work sessions

[03:12:56] and our retreat day, we do have that one day in April where we have more flexibility where where we're not necessarily having to vote on agenda items, but to use the sort of to try to use our guiding to have a list of things we know we want to hear about over the course of time and use the work sessions and the retreat day to address those like the CTU. Can I ask when I see uh computer science standards is on for june are we due to are the computer standards due for their

[03:13:35] regular seven-year update this year okay so that means we have to have them on in uh means we have the opportunity to review them for initial review and then we have to do public hearings on them and then we do a final that's you know that that's public hearing well uh oh are the computer science coming on in for first review in mark in april or not until so final we're hoping for in june oh okay so that means public hearings in may so maybe you know we're gonna have public hearings

[03:14:13] on that we're gonna have public hearings on accreditation accountability do we have to do public hearings on the soq for buildings or construction in other words maybe think about are there ways to combine some of those public hearing requirements we are the hardest working board in one not just the commonwealth the nation i would say i did say that monday morning tuesday morning i did say that to the usba i said no i have the state board

[03:14:55] Ms. Ashton call the question again, like what is the purpose, and I know we asked for it, so I. Yeah, so I think originally I thought that it was just to understand, and I haven't been here a whole year, so I don't every day every board meeting feels completely brand new to me, although I'm starting to see some things and the work that the team does

[03:15:25] to send us information for Paris is like amazing and so I think of my job as helping to set shape policy of the state of Virginia when it comes to education and to to give feedback and advise the leadership and staff so that we can get what we need to to make policy I think that's kind of summarizing our jobs so then in this this document could get really big and really clunky I think there's a lot of other documents that tell me the rules and regs and procedures because I

[03:16:04] would want to get lost in procedures. I would want to make sure that I know it's coming down the pike in a maybe it's just a year in advance like we know science are coming we know computer science is coming we know math is coming in terms of policy but getting too far out and too far behind this feels like this is actually more work for the staff to do, which I would really be against.

[03:16:37] And I like the question around, like, well, what's the priority? Is there a focus? It doesn't feel like that's the way the work happens, though. It feels like we are kind of constantly reacting, turning, turning, which is great because we have all the information, but then there's sometimes we were like oh we just wish we had a little bit more so I'm just going to call the question again I think this does what we ask you all to do but I would just push us on the like to what end like

[03:17:15] what do we really if a year from now because we had this we were a better group what would be in here again I'm only I'm halfway not even halfway through my first year so they're amazing for yes

[03:17:31] You don't get to do that. I'm new here. I am. I'm very new. Dr. Northern. I was just going to ask, answer a question. Um, just speaking from my own point of view, um, because I am, I still do feel new, um, is that I get a lot out of hearing from, and I know our, the staff here get to hear from school districts all the time about the cool things that are going on in our state.

[03:18:00] And I personally feel like that's one thing I miss, I miss on a board, like, and I think to, to elevate those voices in a public meeting like this, so folks can hear across the state would be one thing that I feel like would be helpful in terms of being able to plan for that ahead and how it's tied into our, our work. And also just hearing from other states. I feel like we learned tremendous. I mean, when I was on the assessment, HB 585, and one thing that the department did and structuring that was bringing in experts from other states. And we learned a ton from that. So I'm just saying, trying to integrate that model in our meeting, I think, will

[03:18:37] improve our work, both the sharing. I mean, again, those are the primary things I was looking for is the sharing of the district ideas and the national and other state experts. And also, sometimes I feel like we're, you know, by virtue of the nature of the work, we're in reaction mode. And it'd be nice sometimes if I felt like personally that it was a little bit of a little bit of of being proactive and not always reactive um that's just me though so I think um I mean as far as what I'm

[03:19:12] thinking about in terms of school divisions sharing out what what they are doing um that's really amazing work which all of them are doing it's some in some form or fashion um you know I I really appreciated the fact that Louisa and Mr. Straley came to do their presentation on chronic absenteeism and the amazing things that they're doing there.

[03:19:38] And so perhaps it's an opportunity for us to look at, you know, whatever other kinds of issues that we have, you know, coming up. Like, Dr. Coons, you guys have launched this Office of Behavioral Health and Wellness.

[03:19:54] is there a school division that's really blowing it out of the water on that you know that we could hear from that would you know really actually maybe energize us in our work because I don't know about y'all but I felt very energized um when my my neighbor Mr. Straley came to give us all of his um good things that are going on there and and so I think these these opportunities that we have

[03:20:21] Then again, I see an innovation conference. Maybe there's something really awesome that's uber innovative that we can hear from. I don't know, I'm looking at some of these other things that are on just this particular list here.

[03:20:40] Well, I think that's what we were hoping to kind of solidify these big buckets. Yes. And then to Dr. Northern's point, we can put a question around these big buckets and then bring a presentation or, you know, depending on the topic, is it a national or is it a local?

[03:20:57] But what would be helpful for us is, A, got it. We need to have the, you know, regulatory, the annual report, the kind of extra buckets there. lines need to be delineated out. But what we were trying to do is get a little bit at what Dr.

[03:21:14] Northern was, this kind of bucket. Okay, so these are one of these big priorities. So what is the guiding question? And then we can definitely add in some of these elements. But does the overarching flow of the big buckets so that we can come back and then put some guiding questions and add in some school presentations? We can do all of the things you guys are talking about. But what we tried to do in this document was at least take your six priorities break them out into areas we're happy to come back then add that guiding question for some of those pieces i think miss holton your point about april we get an extra month so is that like a whole day on getting the

[03:21:53] accountability ready to go out the door right like very helpful feedback but what we actually tried to do was bucket these into those kind of places so you'll see in july everything about elevating educators, you'll see something about licensure, I teach, grow your own, teaching grant updates, end of year staffing, principal mentorship. We can definitely have the school division come and talk about some of those things. Is this the right rhythm that you're seeing? And then we can wrap these details that you're talking about. Those are really helpful. So I think your question about

[03:22:31] And I think it is both enabling us to get the balance on the aim towards balance on proactive versus reactive. But that means we do need to have the priorities in and the sort of mandated responsibilities in.

[03:22:52] And then, so to me, the goal is a planning document that we can use for our own scheduling, but also for the board's scheduling so that the agendas don't get too bunched up one month and then we have spare time another month.

[03:23:07] Not that we ever have spare time, but also so we can find, make sure that our agendas do reflect our part. And the one thing I would say is one lens I would use is making sure you're focusing on the things that the board does have action points on.

[03:23:25] So one of our core responsibilities that we are the be-all and end-all on is the SLS, the content standard. So that is something that we, it's quite, that we spend a lot of time on. But to think, okay, if we're going to do computer science soon, and if we're aiming to try to finalize Zoom, and that means that this April, we need to be at least, we need to be able to do at least by April, and we need to be figuring out how

to be public here and to reconnect. So that's sort of the scheduling and planning purpose, and so thinking about our core responsibilities and our priorities.

[03:24:01] And I would say on the SOLs, you know, on the SOLs, one of our core things is we do, we've got the first review, we do final review, we do textbooks, we do assessment cut scores at some point, we don't do curriculum framework anymore, that, you know, there are sort of standard steps along the process for each of our ump-y-ump different content areas, and it's not just math, science, reading, in history in Virginia.

[03:24:31] it is arts and computer science, et cetera, et cetera. So they're all on a seven year cycle. And when we accelerate one or slow down another, I do have questions, for instance, the history. Okay, we adapted the history standards in the spring and we've basically heard very little about them since then.

[03:24:49] Are we gonna do textbook adoption? Presumably we are gonna do some textbook adoption consistent with the new history standards. This year, I think I have heard informally, I don't know if we, maybe it's in the church formally, that the history standards are now going to be rolled out they're basically going to split behind the literacy and math so they won't be rolled out until 25 26 but what does that need what do we need to do before then we need to text books let's not wait till we're behind the gun on textbooks let's do it at the right time so we have enough time for school divisions to be able to go

[03:25:25] through their purchases and then when we need to i don't think we actually have much of a role in the assessment other than setting the tax scores but that is our role so so anyway those again that would be some of our core responsibilities is the sol and certainly the accountability accreditation is part of our core responsibility please the beauty of this board i've come to conclude like these two i feel new a lot of times uh is that uh we have such differing opinions

[03:26:01] but yet they all work so well together because when Amber was talking earlier I was thinking exactly what you were thinking. I love seeing the weeds that came. I love being proactive instead of all even reactive. So then when you asked the question of what's the purpose that was good too but just in a perspective of what are we doing here and I had a professor in So that's what I think about when I think about having a good time and share with them

[03:26:35] It's very easy to get the task to be, you know, to get the task to be, you know, to get the task on what you're going to do in a daily basis.

[03:26:57] And so I'm just adding on what everybody's saying.

[03:27:04] I think that's great, great, great observations.

[03:27:38] My next thing would just be to differentiate some of those. So the idea of a featured division, that's great, but I think that should also fit into whatever topic we're on, just like Chronic Apostles and Lewis. That was a good example. Also, I don't know if we want to get into, I don't want to limit ourselves that the only way to feature a division is to bring the whole division in.

[03:27:57] It could also be, you know, here's a one pager from three divisions on a topic. Please use this as part of your agenda prep. You know, I think that there's ways to differentiate that. Similarly, you know, I like the idea of hearing what other states are doing, but our time is so precious. I've kind of liked the experts have come in and one expert has told us what six states are doing. I kind of appreciate that meta analysis of what states are doing, to me, would probably be a little more appealing than individuals.

[03:28:26] And then I also, you know, Dr. Coons, I encourage you to look at the things that you've already done for us that maybe we haven't given due credit to. I'm sure some of us have, you know, scanned through the special ed reports that you commissioned, that you had prepared. But, you know, something like that, knowing that there's two big omnibus special ed bills coming through the General Assembly right now, it would probably be proactive for us to be thinking about some of the things you've already gathered for us.

[03:28:53] So now this is great. I just like to link to the big topic, how we feature a division or school could vary. And I like to hear about lots of states whenever possible. And I wrote this like we want to have insights from the field, whether it's local or national, constantly woven in.

[03:29:18] We want to have a big question. And the I think the thing that I heard and want to emphasize is like I actually want to hear the results, too. And that's like, we implemented something. How is it going? We did a whole accountability system. What are the results of it? And so somehow it's like, because we're doing so much and sometimes it doesn't have to be a presentation, but it could be a, hey, this just happened. Read it. We'll come back to it.

[03:29:50] That's actually one of the things we pushed on. So if you look at priority two, it has an all-in update, a learning recovery data reporting, a learning recovery year two. That was the hope was to kind of create this rhythm so that you could come back. Because I do feel, and you guys have said to me, we never heard talk on that.

[03:30:07] So we tried to create some of a rhythm in particular around your priority expectations so that there's this cyclical piece of that. So we come back and talk about it. So for example, you've got innovation on priority four, then it's okay. So here's a broader update. Here's an update. So we were trying to start to create that rhythm. Like you'll see, here's the launch of the behavioral office. Here's what the office is doing. And then why don't we give you some updates in November?

[03:30:34] So we are trying to kind of start picking that up. So I hope as you guys kind of look through, you'll see some of that rhythm and cycle was in hopes to do that. Yeah, that's great. Yeah. Okay. Well, I think that we have a direction and I'm just going to summarize to make sure because sometimes I walk away and I think I hear what you said, but I want to make sure. So there's definitely this lovely balance, as Debbie put it, between the scheduling and the

[03:31:10] planning and making sure that we're getting proactive with some of our things like our action points our sols our stakeholder engagement things like that making sure too that we have these themes with the guiding questions that we can spend a portion of our work session on and potentially either have a school district presentation one pagers from school divisions but connecting it to the work in virginia but also connecting it to the national landscape versus a particular state in general if that's possible and then making sure that the the things that the board has priorities

[03:31:46] and responsibilities over whether it's standards textbooks things like that that those are clearly evident and woven throughout anything else that i've missed that you've requested as we move for our work plan in march did you say the public yeah yeah the public engagement yep so take it to a year yeah yeah march to march yes what we will do is we'll try to put something together and then send it out midterm and get you guys to redline it. And then you can give us feedback. So probably dependent on how busy we are in the next few weeks. We get that to you early,

[03:32:23] mid February, and then get your feedback and then have the opportunity to get it posted. Great. Thanks. Appreciate the feedback. All right. Do you have anything else before we close for the day. Okay. And council has encouraged us to adjourn for the day. We are adjourned.

